

Solar-Powered Rover

By Team 66:

William Mancuso (EE), Bowen Williamson (EE),
Margaret Burkes (EE), Keldon Ngo (EE), Kenny
Bui (EE)

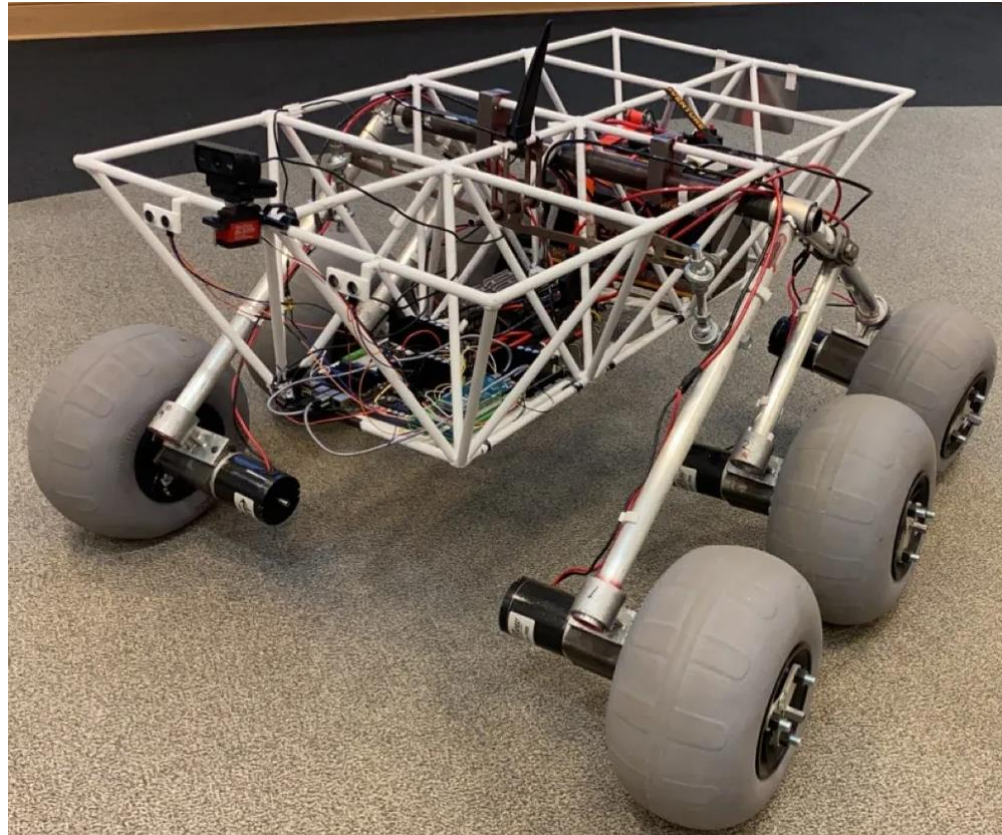
Project Sponsor: Dr. Xiangyu Meng

Faculty Advisor: Dr. Shahab Mehraeen



Project Background:

Land
Optimized
Uppgradeable
Interplanetary
System

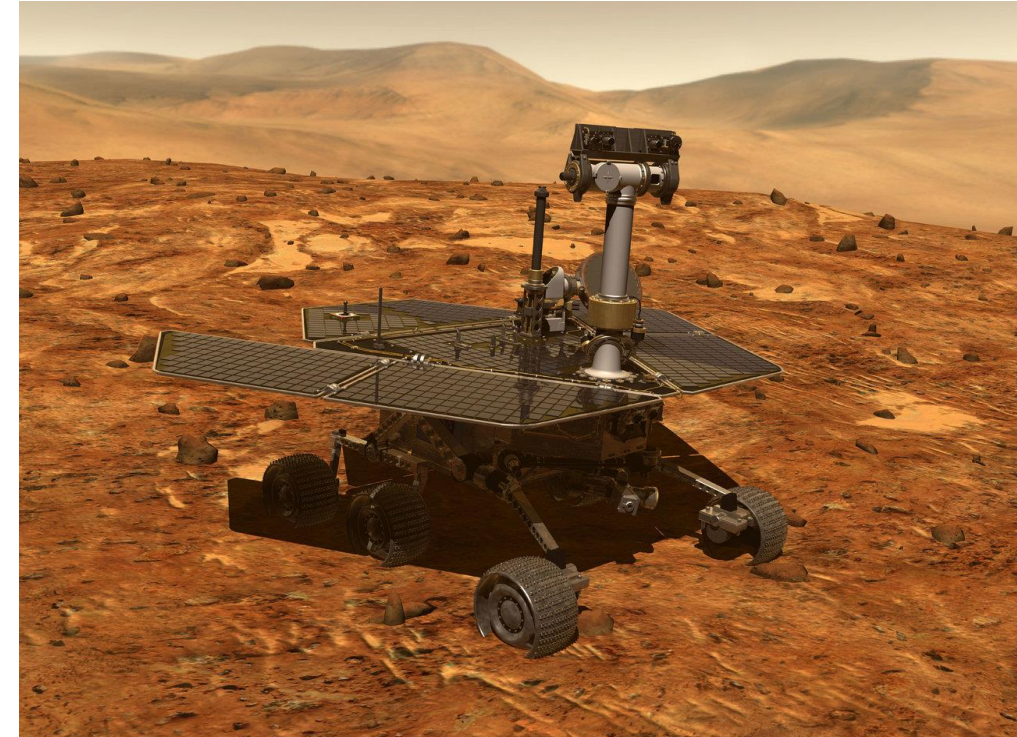


Objective Statement

The main objective of this project is enhancing the previously built rover, which is battery powered, by integrating solar power, autonomous power switching between solar and battery power, and an independent cleaning system for the solar panel.

Existing and Competing Technologies:

- Nasa Spirt Rover:
 - Key Similarities
 - Mainly solar power rover
 - Used for environmental exploration
 - Key differences
 - Built for Martian weather
 - No Self-Cleaning System



Functional Requirements

#	Weight	Function	Explanation
F1	0.4	Convert solar energy to power the rover.	Utilize solar panels to absorb sunlight as an additional power source to the battery power.
F2	0.35	Autonomously switch power between power sources.	Autonomously switch between battery and solar power.
F3	0.25	Clean the solar panels.	Intermittently clean off debris from solar panel to maximize energy absorption and efficiency.

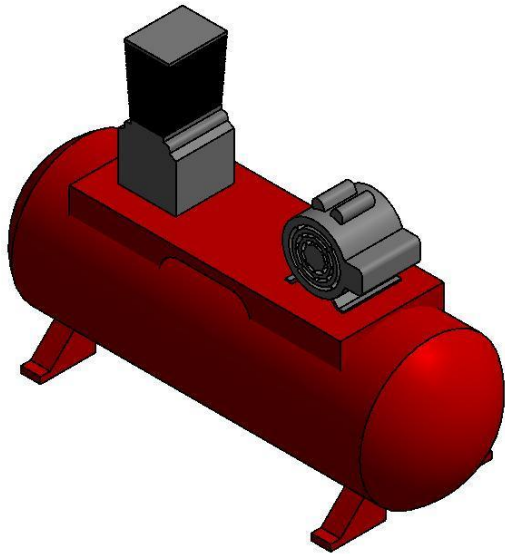
Qualitative Constraints

#	Weight	Qualitative Constraint	Explanation
Q1	0.40	Compatibility with Existing Design	Ensure the implementations to the previous rover are compliant with each other. The additions should merge with the existing design seamlessly.
Q2	0.35	Weatherproof Design	The solar panel system should be built to withstand the elements of Louisiana such as wind, precipitation, and heat.
Q3	0.25	Portability	Make sure that the system doesn't hinder the transportation of the rover. Should be convenient to maneuver without disassembly.

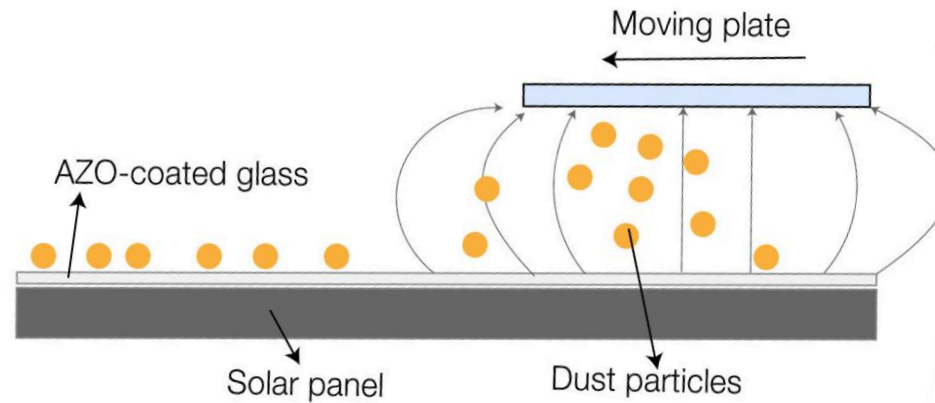
Quantitative Constraints

#	Weight	Name	Symbol	Units	Expected Value(s)	Measured Value(s)	Explanation
M1	0.5	Budget	B	\$	4000	3525	A budget of \$4000 was decided upon by the sponsor.
M2	0.4	Interior Space	S	M ³	0.977	0.971	This was the amount of available space inside the rover's chassis to install new electronic components.
M3	0.1	Weight Limit	W	Kg	<36.3	36.2	The max additional weight load was measured at 36.3kg. The team would like to stay under this variable.

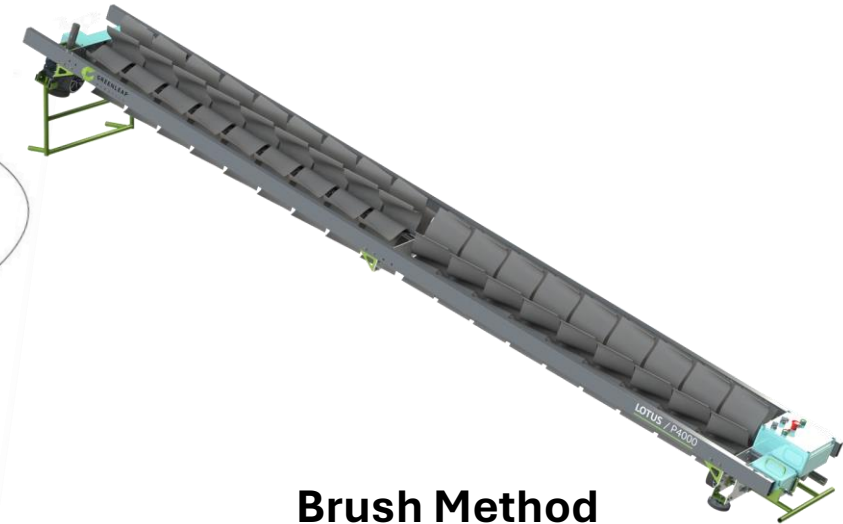
Concept Generation: Self-Cleaning



Air Compressor Method



Electrostatic Method



Brush Method

Concept Evaluation & Selection: Self-Cleaning

		Concepts		
Criterion	Weights	Air Compressor	Electrostatic Method	Brush Method
Cost	30	0	-1	1
Cleans Effectively	25	-1	1	0
Mass	20	-1	0	1
Non-abrasive	20	0	1	-1
Maintenance	5	-1	1	0
Weighted Total	100	-0.5	0.2	0.3

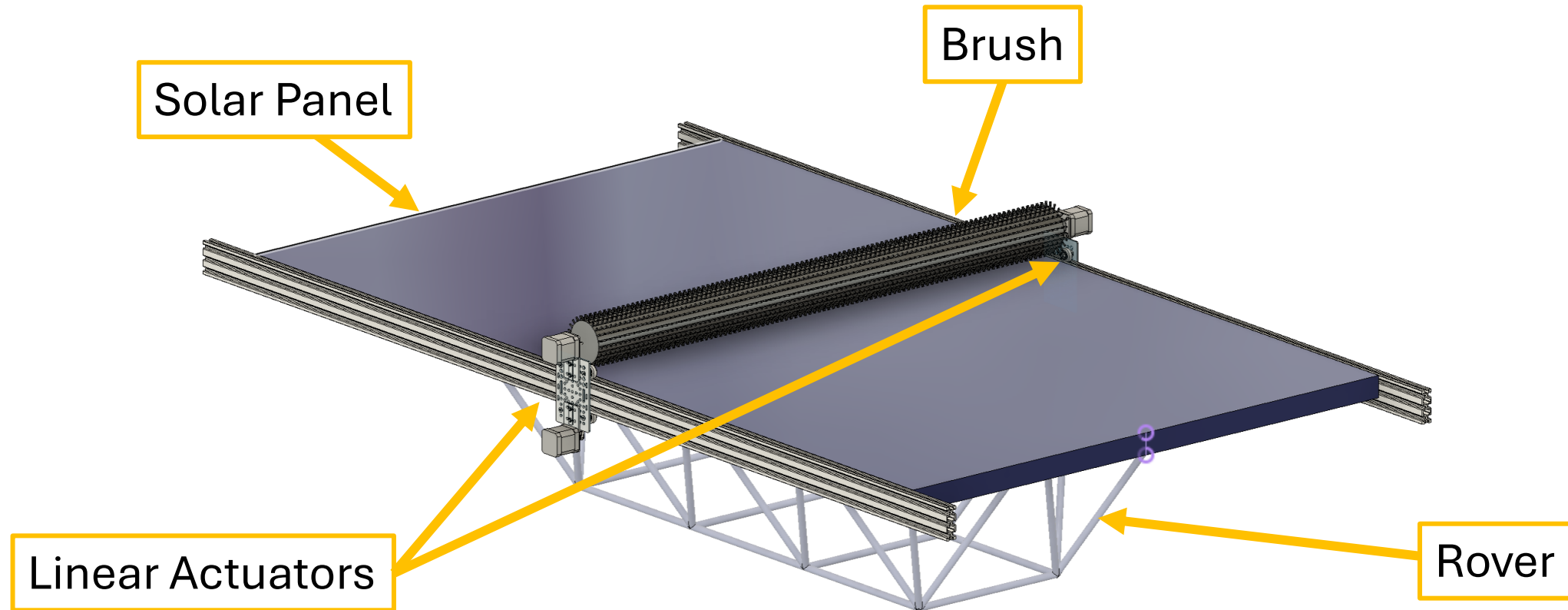
Concept Evaluation & Selection: Solar Panel

		Concepts		
Criterion	Weights	Thin Film	Polycrystalline	Monocrystalline
Efficiency	40	-1	0	1
Cost	25	1	0	-1
Weight	20	1	-1	-1
Life-span	15	-1	1	1
Weighted Total	100	-.1	-.05	0.1

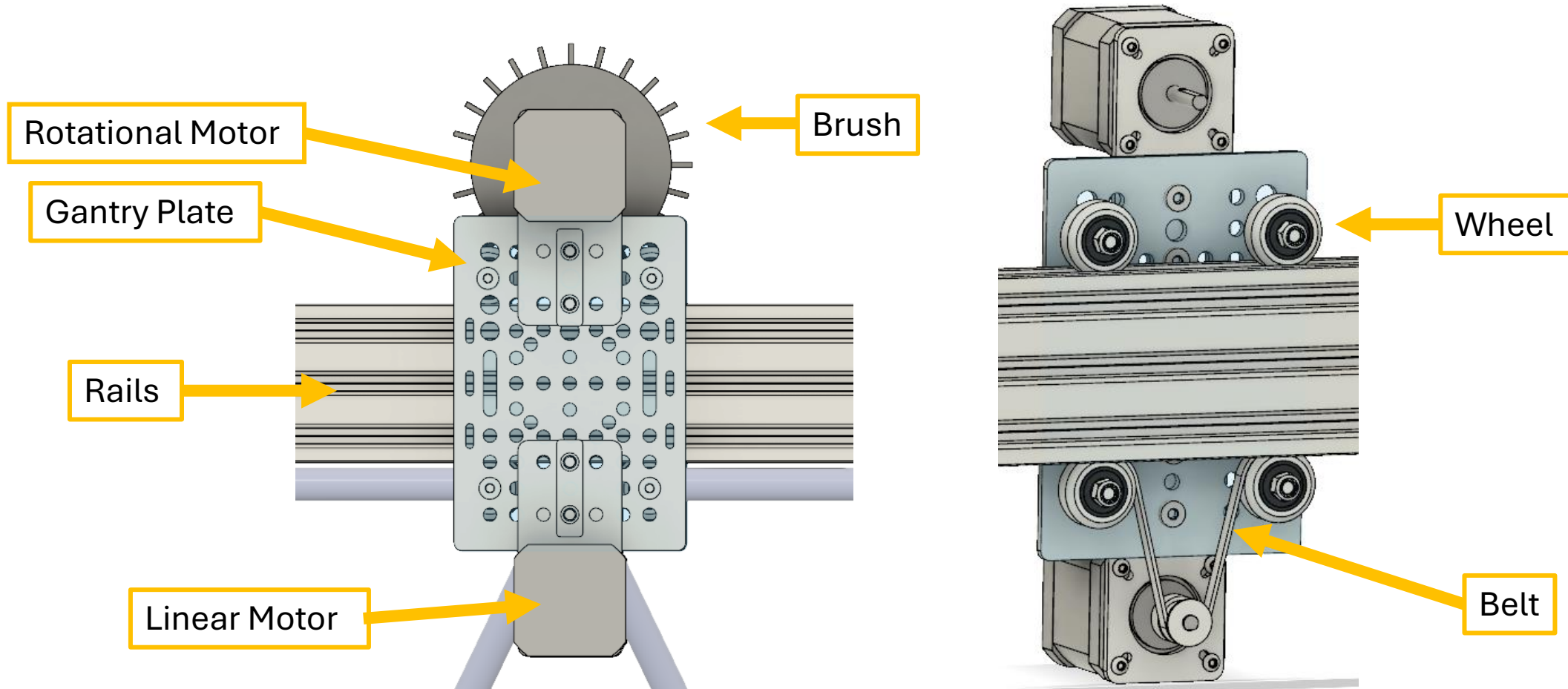
Concept Selection:

	Solar Panel Cleaning System	Autonomous Power Flow	Solar Panel
Concepts	Industrial Brush Corp. Brush Method	MorningStar Solar Charge Controller	REC Alpha Monocrystalline panel

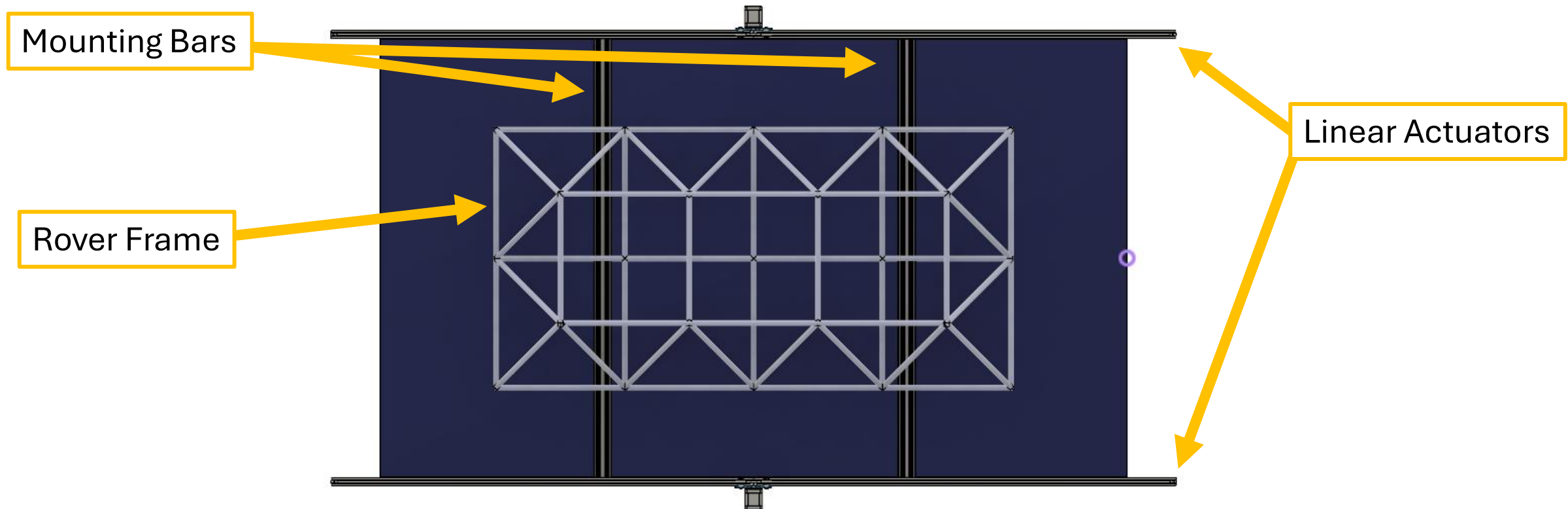
Product Architecture



Product Architecture – Linear Actuator

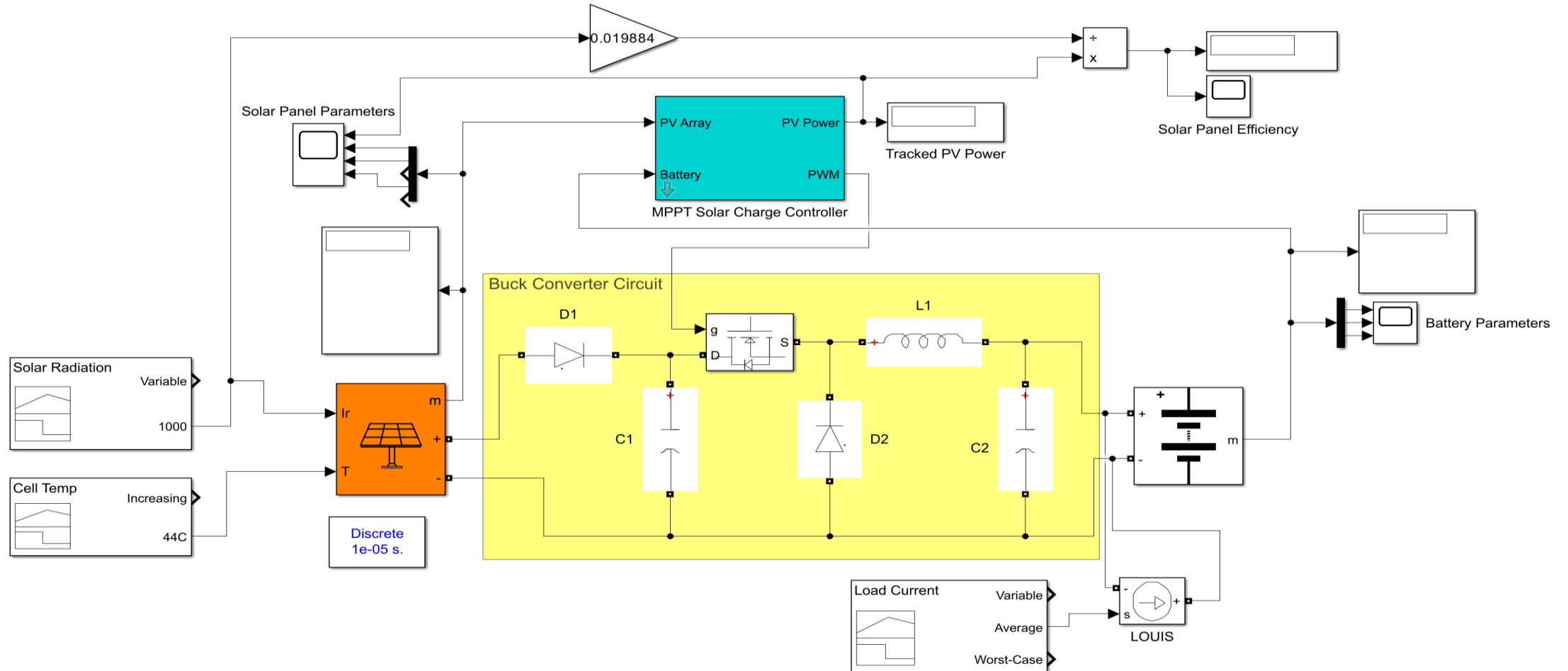


Product Architecture – Rover



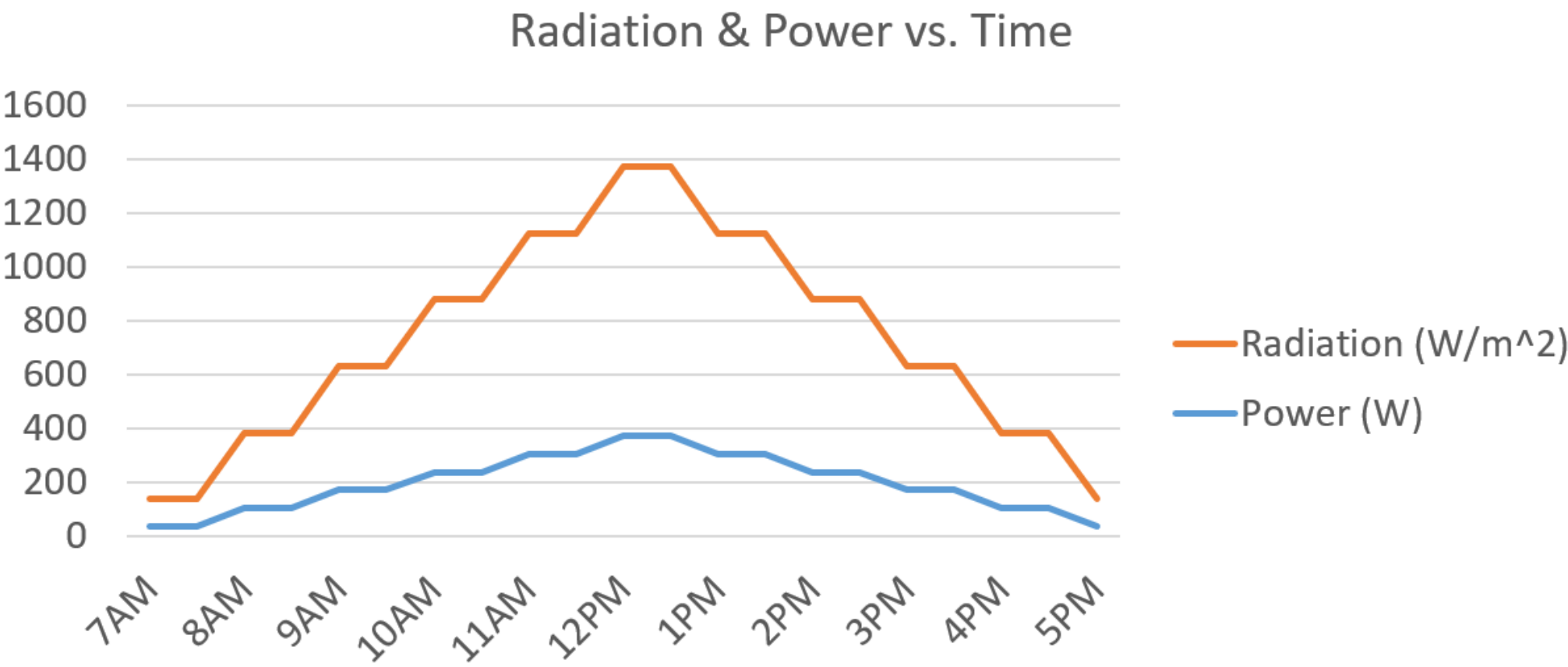
Engineering Analysis: Charge Controller

MPPT Solar Charge Controller Model



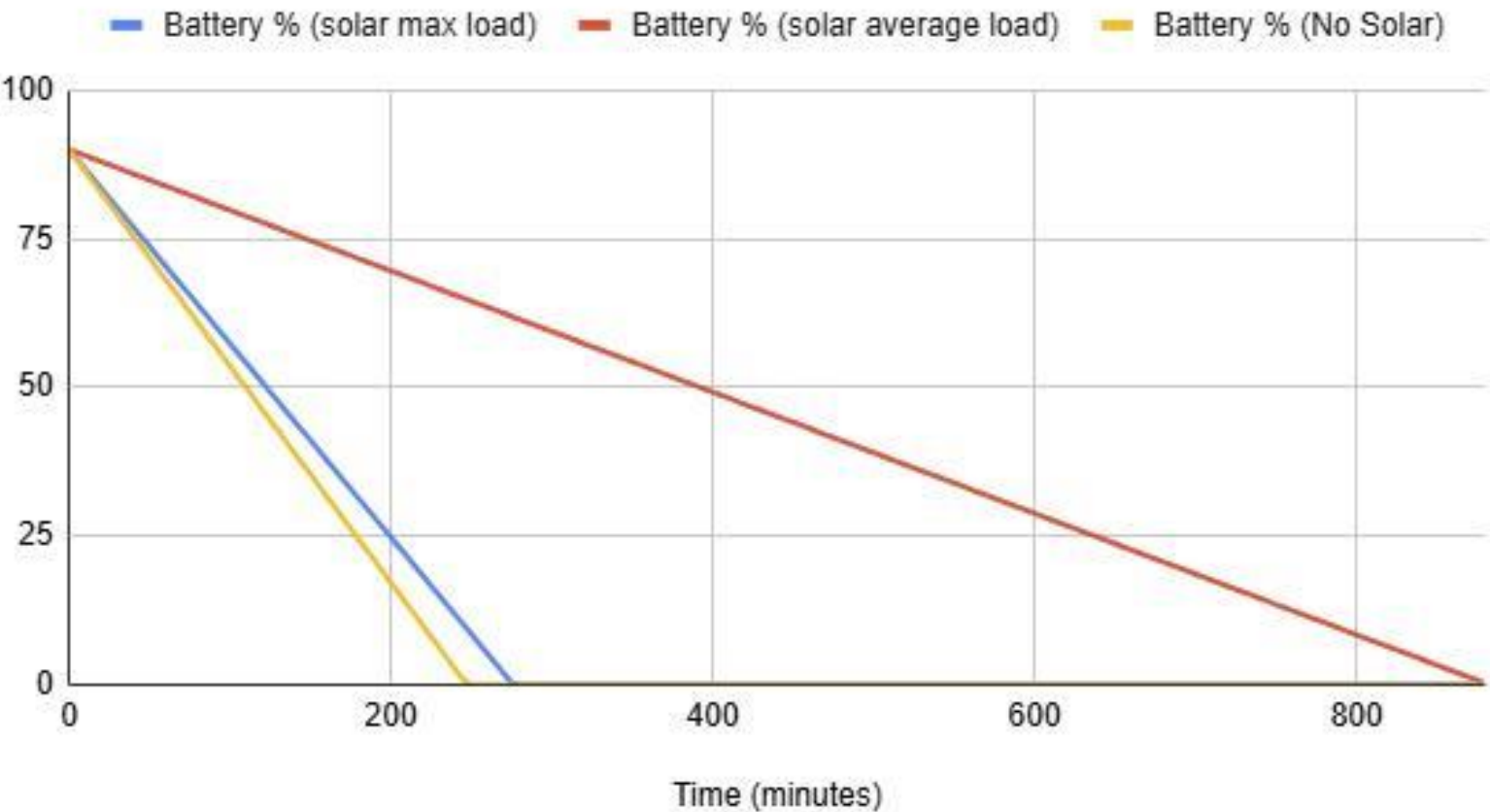
Engineering Analysis: Charge Controller

Effects of Solar Radiation on Power Production

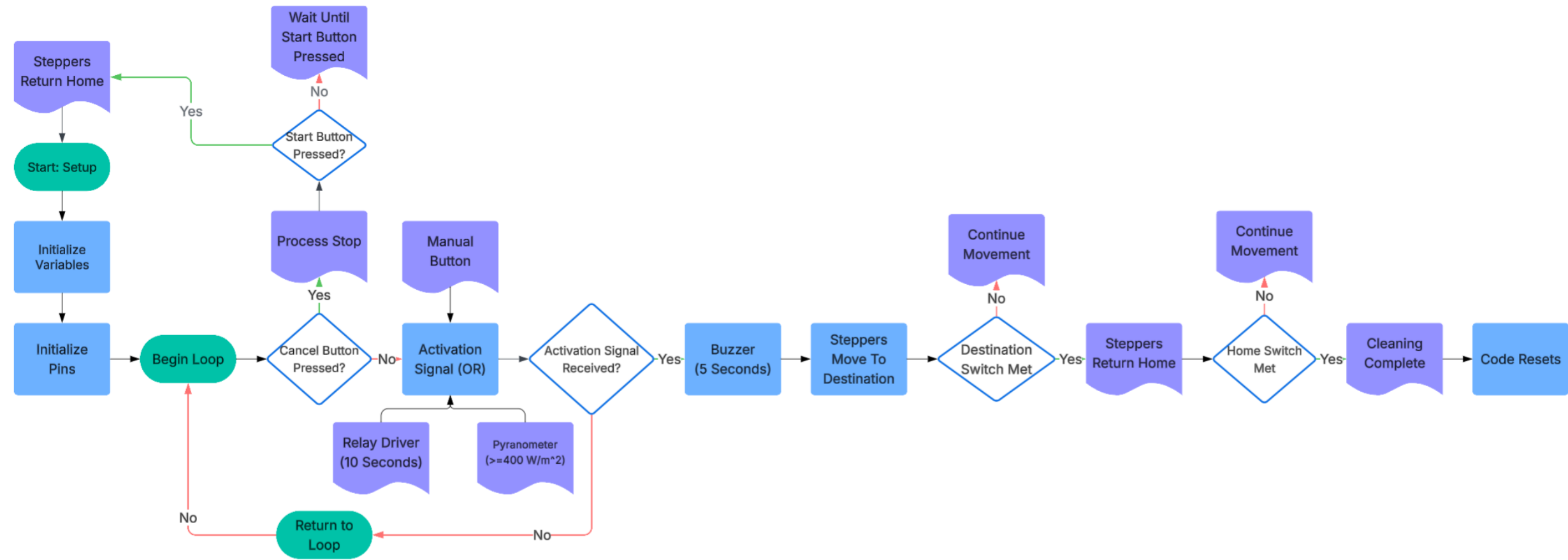


Engineering Analysis: Charge Controller

Solar Charge Controller Analysis



Engineering Analysis: Cleaning Activation



Engineering Analysis: Linear Motion Motor

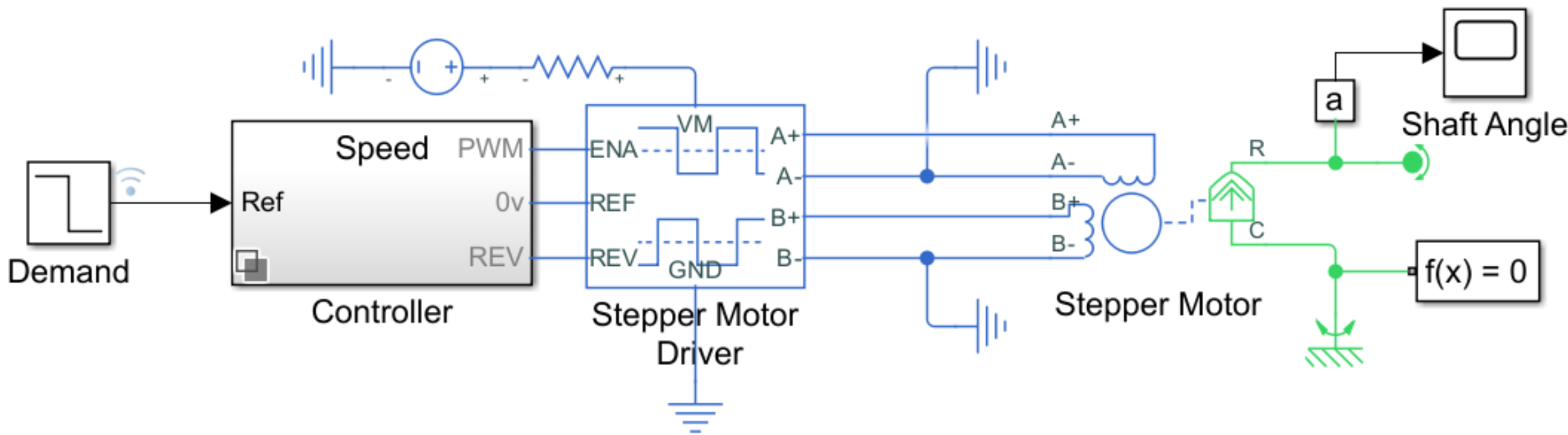
- $M = 3.35kg$

- $\frac{d\omega_m}{dt} = 15.71 rad/s^2$

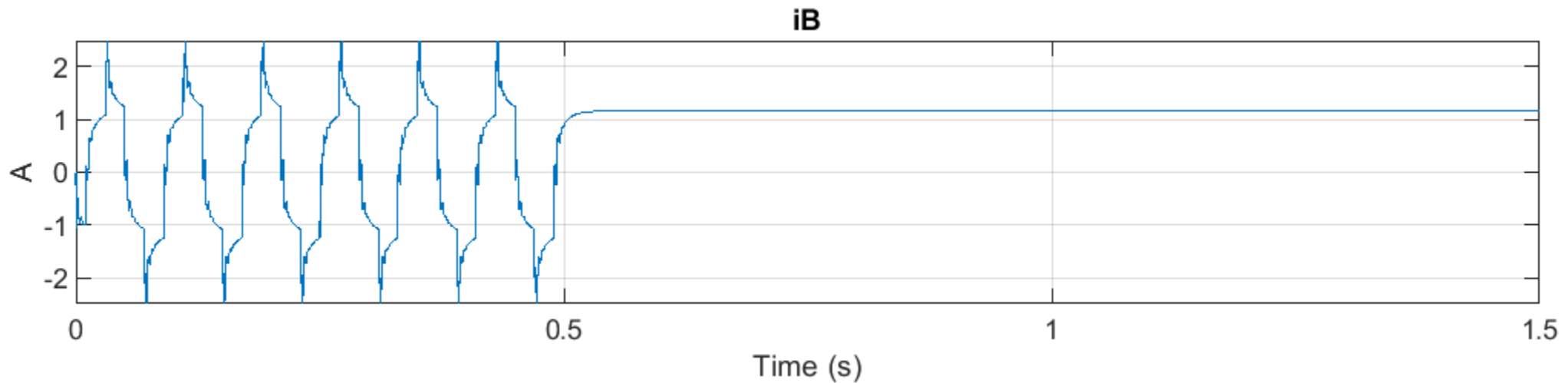
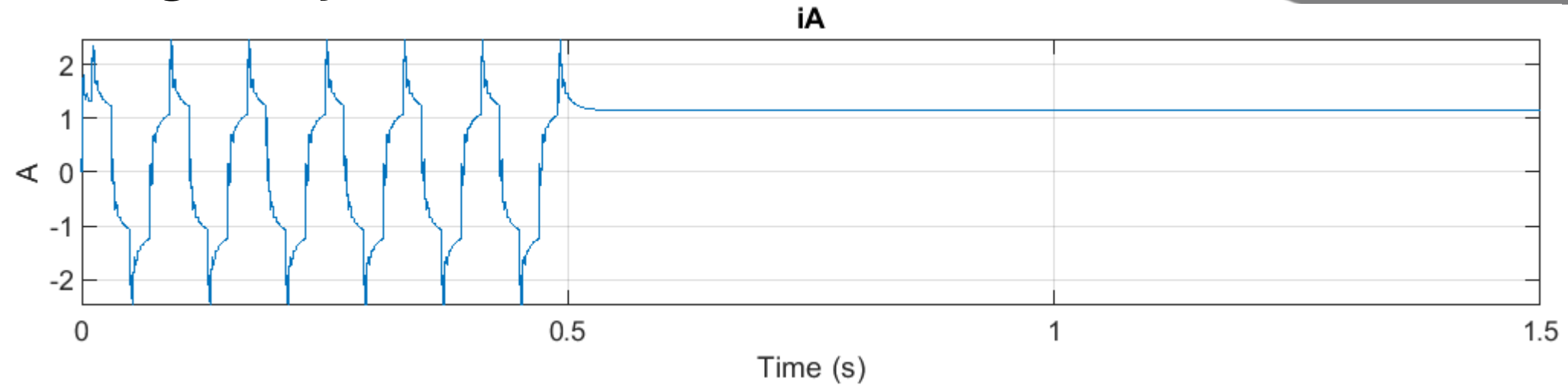
- $r = \frac{(\# \text{ of teeth})(pitch)}{2\pi} = \frac{20 \times 3mm}{2\pi} = 9.5mm$

- $T_{em} = \frac{1}{2}Mr^2 \frac{d\omega_m}{dt} + r^2M \frac{d\omega_m}{dt} + r f_l = 0.31 Nm$

Engineering Analysis: Linear Motion Motor



Engineering Analysis: Linear Motion Motor



Engineering Analysis: DC Geared Motor

Moment of Inertia

$$I = \frac{1}{3}mL^2$$

$$I = \frac{1}{3} * 0.186 * (3)^2 = 0.558 \text{ slug/ft}^2$$

$$L = 3 \text{ ft} \quad m = \frac{6}{32.2} = 0.186$$

Steady-state Torque

$$\text{Friction} = \mu * N = 0.3 * 6 = 1.8 \text{ lb}$$

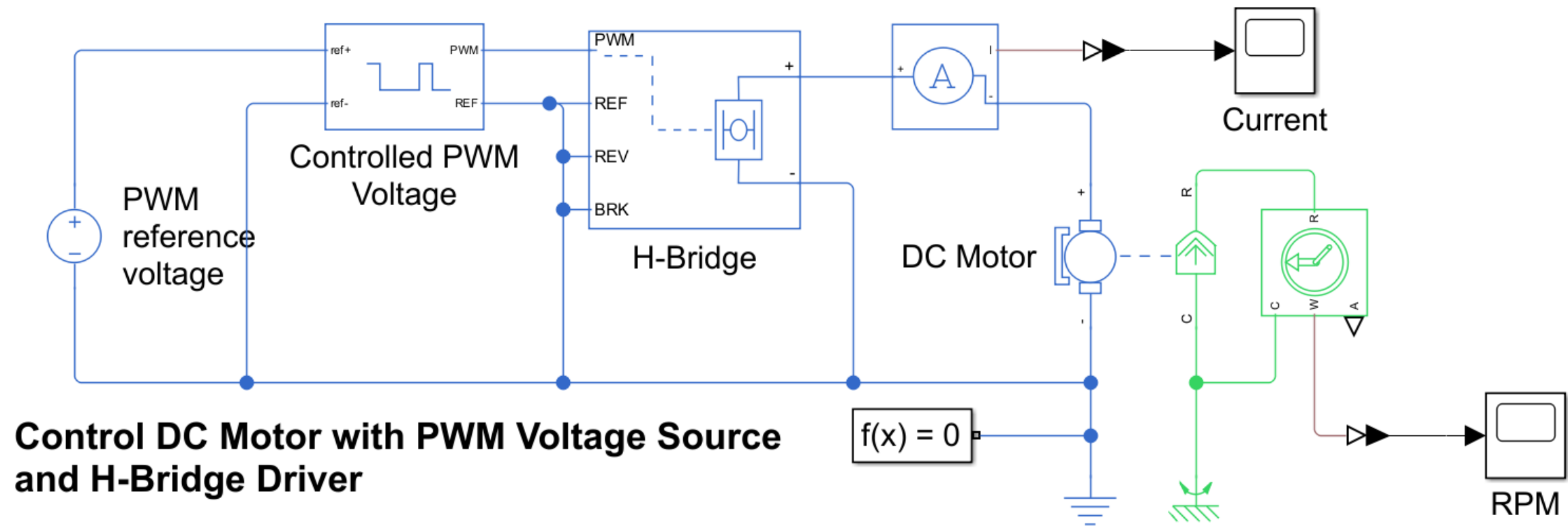
$$T_s = F * r = 1.8 * 2 = 3.6 \text{ lb/in}$$

Torque-speed relationship

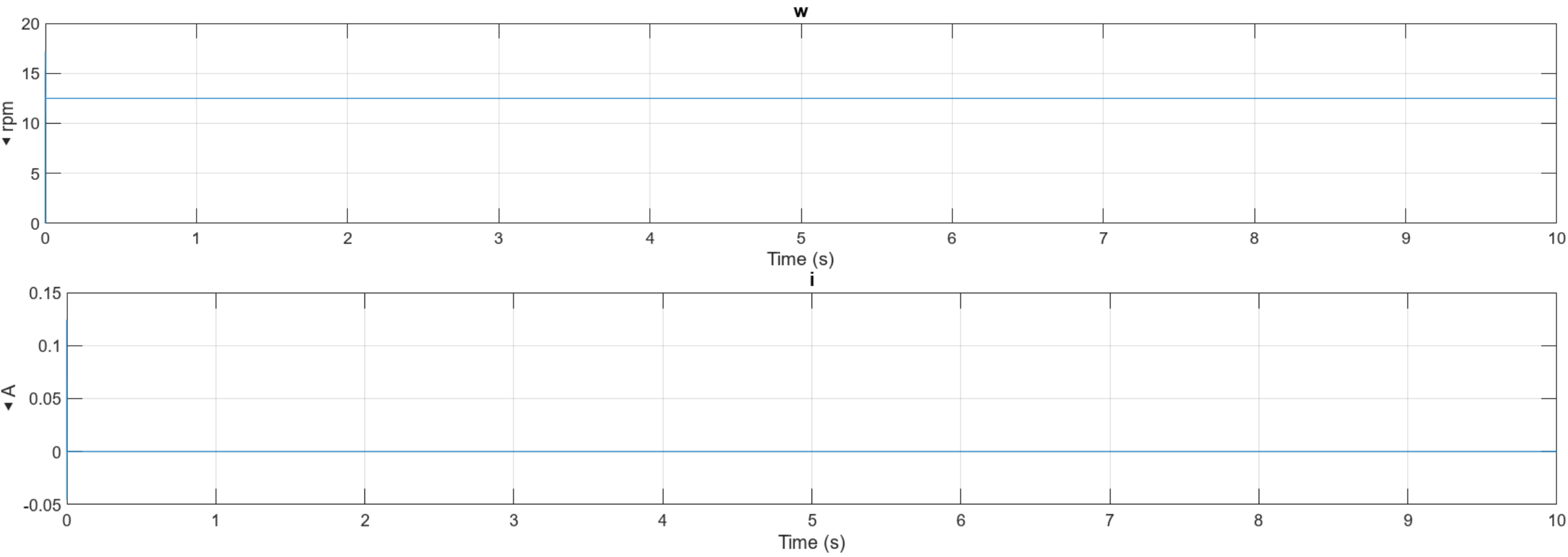
$$\frac{T_{load}}{T_{rated}} = 1 - \frac{N_{load}}{N_{no-load}}$$

$$\frac{T_{load}}{8} = 1 - \frac{13}{25} = 0.48 \rightarrow T_{load} = 0.48 * 8 = 3.84 \text{ lb-in}$$

Engineering Analysis: DC Geared Motor



Engineering Analysis: DC Geared Motor



Engineering Analysis: Overall Circuit Load

Original Circuit Load Analysis

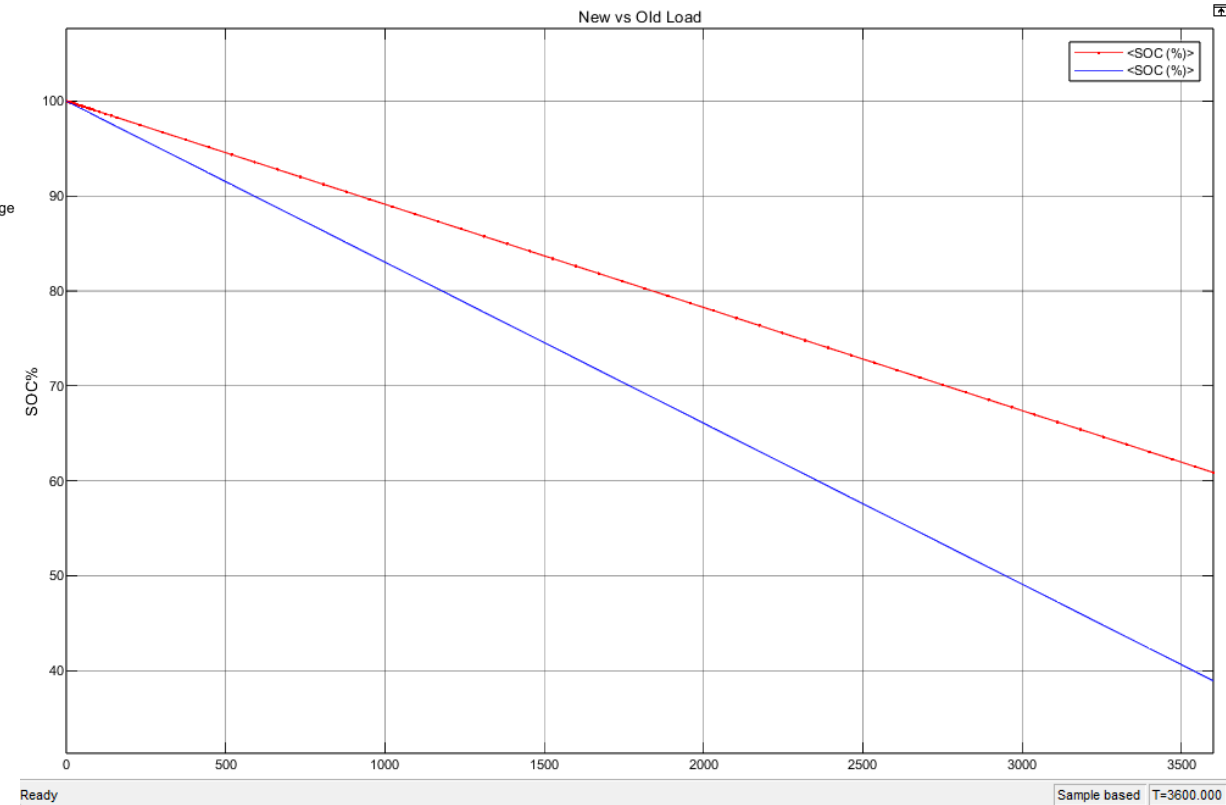
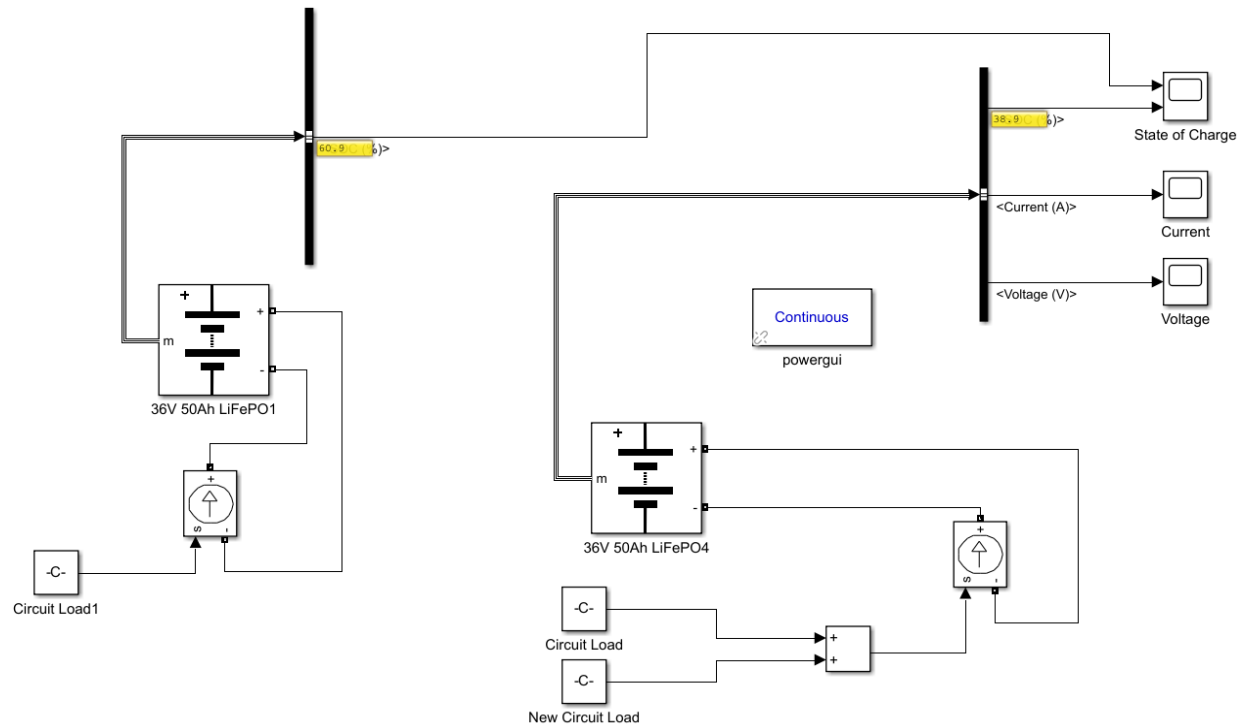
Load #	A*min	Ah
1	65.5	1.0916667
2	74.5	1.2416667
3	43.32	0.722
4	37.34	0.6223333
5	131	2.1833333
6	149	2.4833333
7	36.46	0.6076667
8	131	2.1833333
9	36.46	0.6076667
10	131	2.1833333
11	100.045	1.6674167
12	18.44	0.3073333
13-21	33.402	0.5567
22	48	0.8
23	150	2.5
Total		19.757783

Additional Circuit Load Analysis

Load	A*min	Ah
Arduino Uno	0.0083	0.5
NEMA 23 Stepper Motors (Idle)	0.0555	3.33
NEMA 23 Stepper Motors (Running)	0.111	6.67
TB6600 Motor Drivers	0.0067	0.4
DC Brush Motor	0.002	0.125
L298N Motor Driver	0.0006	0.036
Charge Controller	0	0
MorningStar RD-1	0.0001	0.006
Buzzer	0.00025	0.015
		11.082

Load Calculation Conducted by Previous Group

Engineering Analysis: Overall Circuit Load



Red: Original Load (60.9%) Blue: New Load (38.9%)

Component Selection: Solar Panel

REC Pure-RX Solar Panel

Power Output	450 W
Efficiency	21.6%
Power Density	20.1 W/m ²
Nominal Power Voltage	54.3 V
Nominal Power Current	8.29 A



Component Selection: Solar Charge Controller

MorningStar TriStar-MPPT-30

Operating Voltage	9 V
Nominal Battery Voltage	12, 24, 36, or 48 V
Charge Rating	30 A
Max PV Power	1200 W
Max PV Voc	150 V



Component Selection: Relay Driver

MorningStar RD-1

Operating Voltage	8-68V
Max Channel Current	750 mA
Voltage Accuracy	2% $\pm$ 50 mV
Transient Surge Protection	1500 W



Component Selection: Pyranometer

Apogee Instruments SP-215-SS

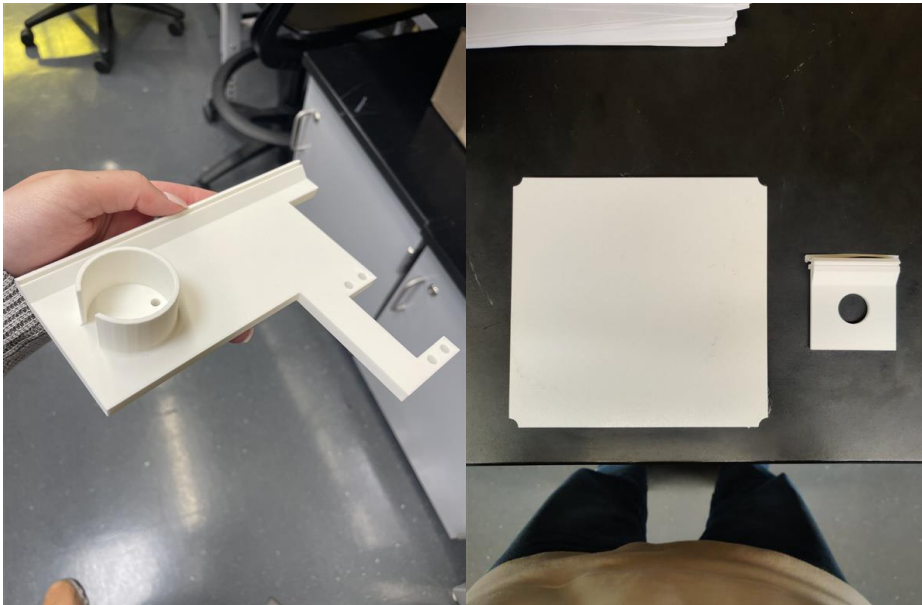
Operating Voltage	5.5-24 V
Current Draw	300 μ A
Output Voltage	0-5 V
Response Time	< 1 ms



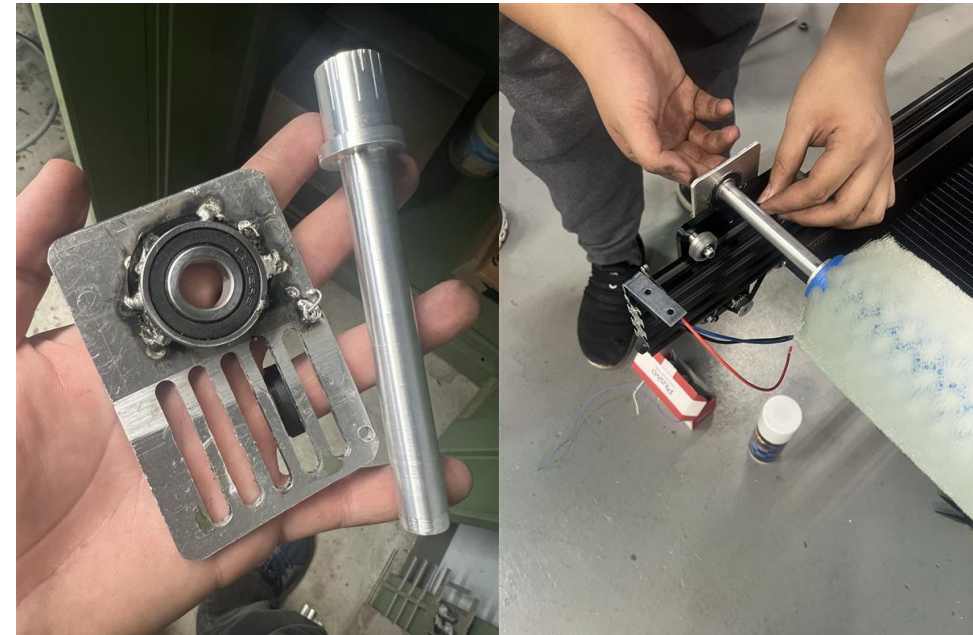
Manufacturing Timeline

January	Manufacturing Plans and Order Parts
February	3D Prints (Parts and Stencils)
March	Frame Assembly and Machining Practice
April	Motor Housing and Connectors

Manufacturing

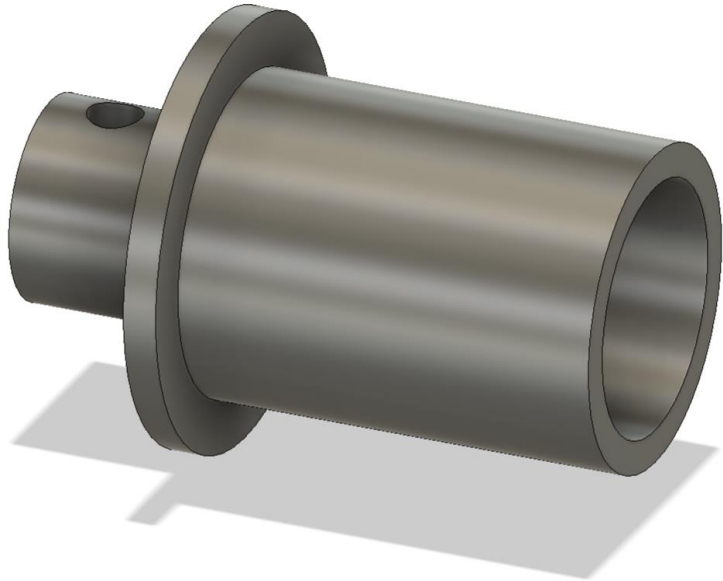


3D printed parts to hold components



Gantry Plates and Flange Couplings

Manufacturing



Flange coupling
3D model

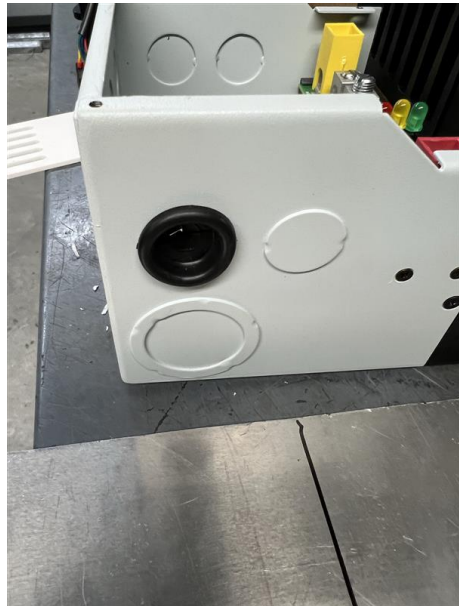


Flange coupling
being turned on lathe

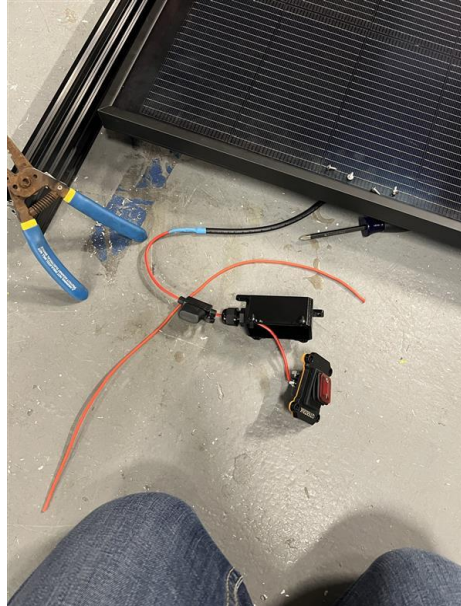


Welding of the t-track rails to the panel

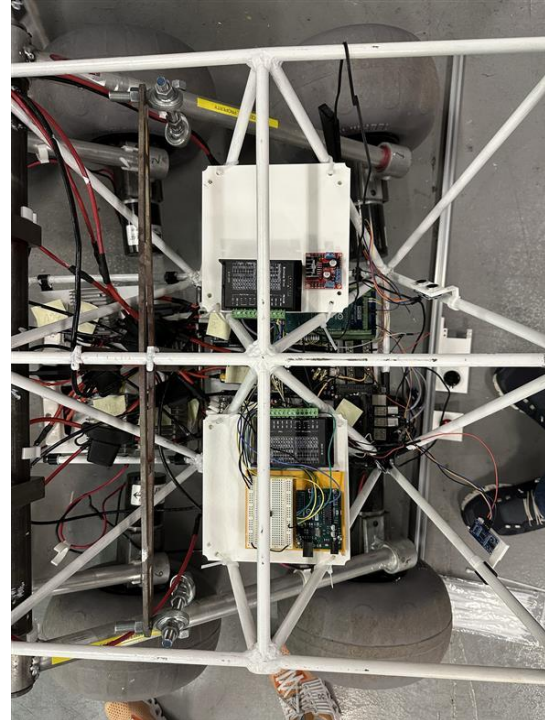
Manufacturing: Electrical



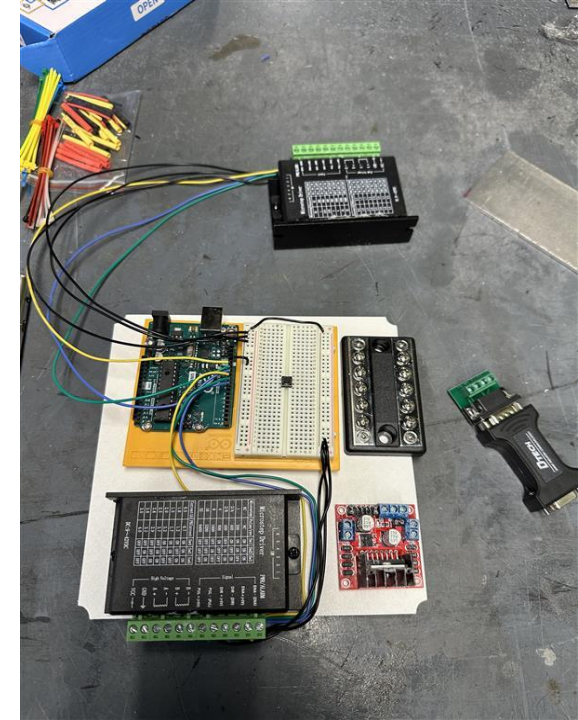
Wire grommets for charge controller



Removing the panel IP68 cable connector to add a switch



Electronics wiring and 3D printed plates for securing



Manufacturing: Design Enhancements



Broken axle



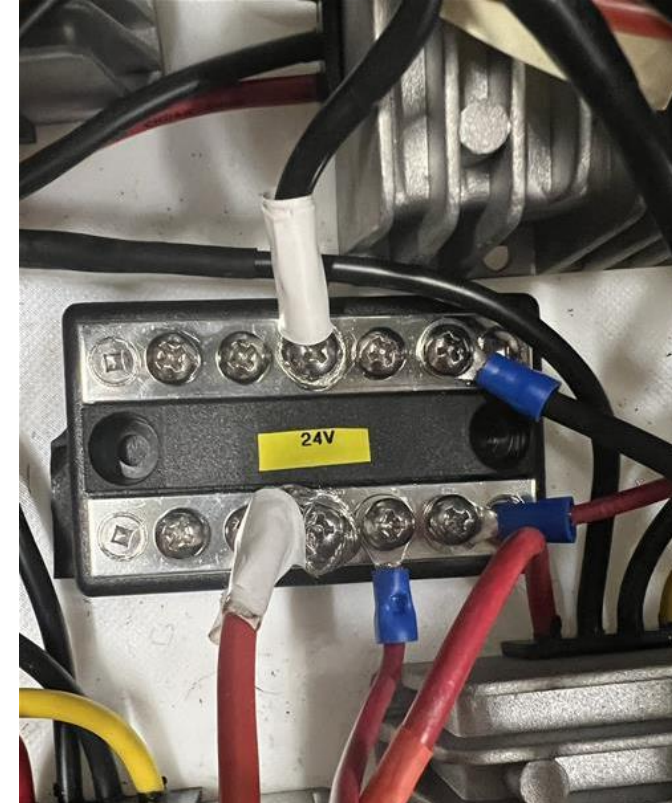
New and improved axle design



Manufacturing: Design Enhancements

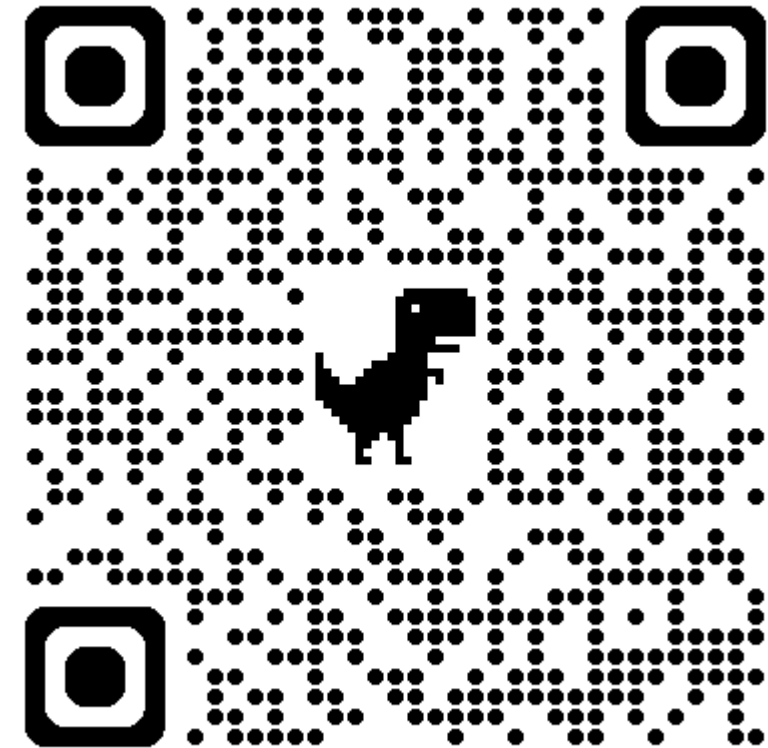
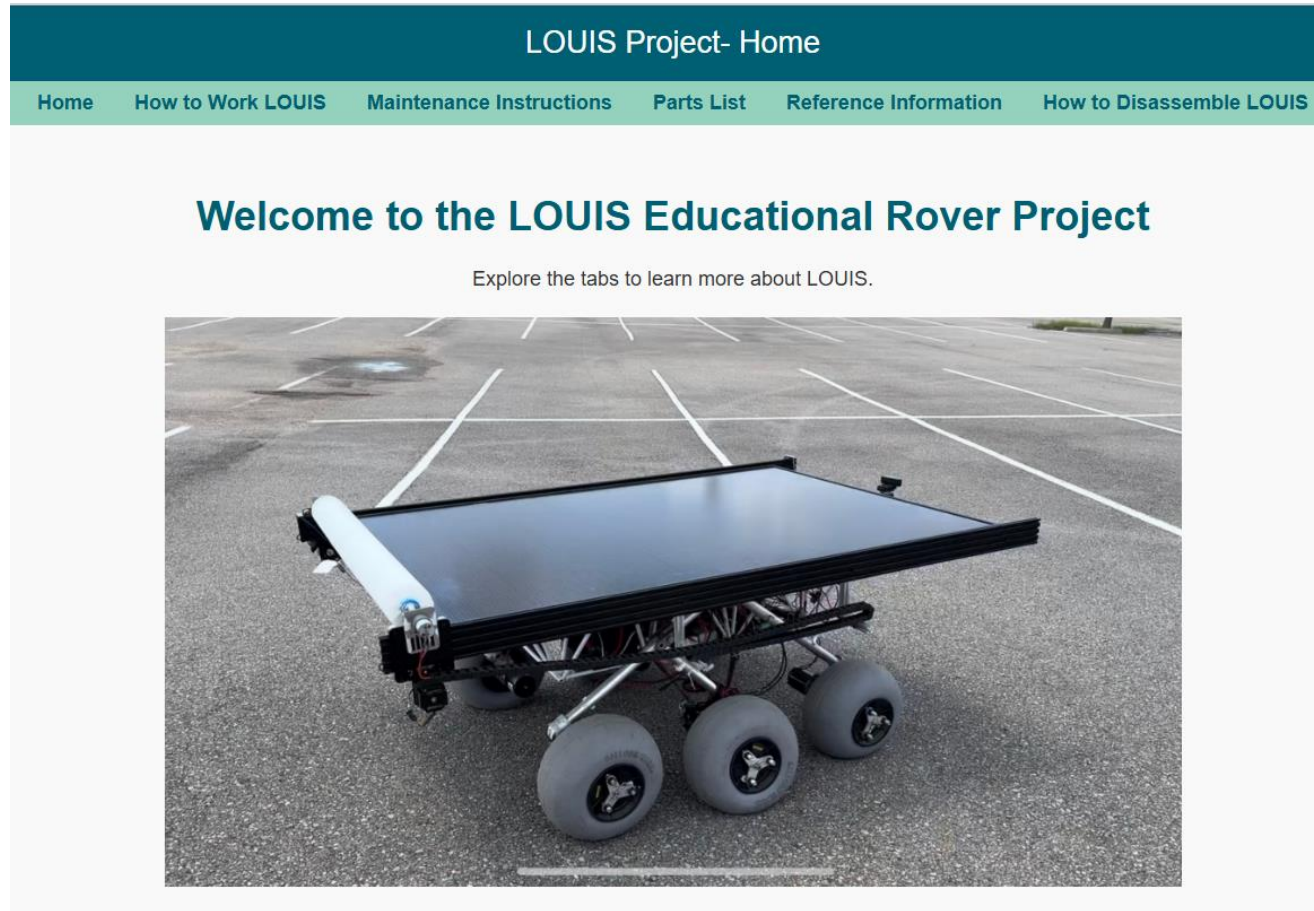


Washers on the rocker pivot
to have a tighter fit



24V Bus bar and labels

Manufacturing: Website



Testing and Validation: Solar Panel

Sunny Condition Test:

Day:	Time:	Voltage:	Current:	Power:
2/25	11:33AM	50.1V	7.0 A	350.7 W
2/25	11:39AM	50.3V	7.1A	357.1 W
4/25	12:15PM	54.9V	8 A	439 W



Testing and Validation: Solar Panel

Cloudy/Partly Cloudy Condition Test:

Day:	Time:	Voltage:	Current:	Power:
3/13	10:58AM	51.5V	8.3A	427.5 W
3/13	11:06AM	48.6V	7.8A	379.1 W
3/19	3:25PM	50.7V	8.3A	420.8 W
3/19	3:40PM	45.7V	7.3A	333.6 W



Testing and Validation: Solar Panel

Indoor Condition Test:

Day:	Time:	Voltage:	Current:	Power:
3/18	11:18AM	47.6V	6.45A	307.0W
3/18 (wall facing)	11:30AM	21.9V	2.80A	61.3W
3/18	11:35AM	46.9V	6.23A	292.2W



Testing and Validation: Charging and Battery Operation

	Battery % Stationary	Battery % Full-Speed	Battery Life Expectancy
No solar power		-21.34% per hr	4.69 hr
With solar power	+8% per hr	-6.95% per hr	14.39 hr

No Solar:

$$\frac{70\%}{3\text{hr } 17\text{min}} = \frac{70\%}{3.28\text{hr}} = -21.34\% \text{ per hour}$$

Expected Life:

$$100\% \times \frac{1\text{hr}}{21.34\%} = 4.69 \text{ hours}$$

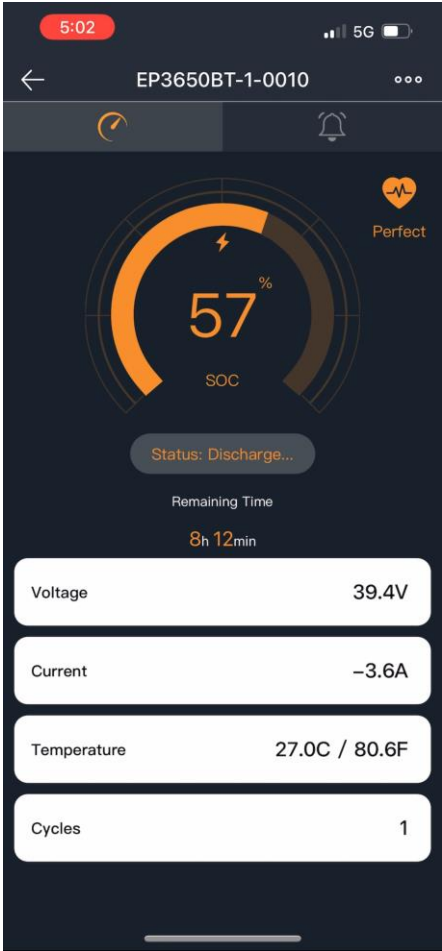
With Solar:

$$\frac{57\%}{8\text{hr } 12\text{min}} = \frac{57\%}{8.2\text{hr}} = -6.95\% \text{ per hour}$$

Expected Life:

$$100\% \times \frac{1\text{hr}}{6.95\%} = 14.39 \text{ hours}$$

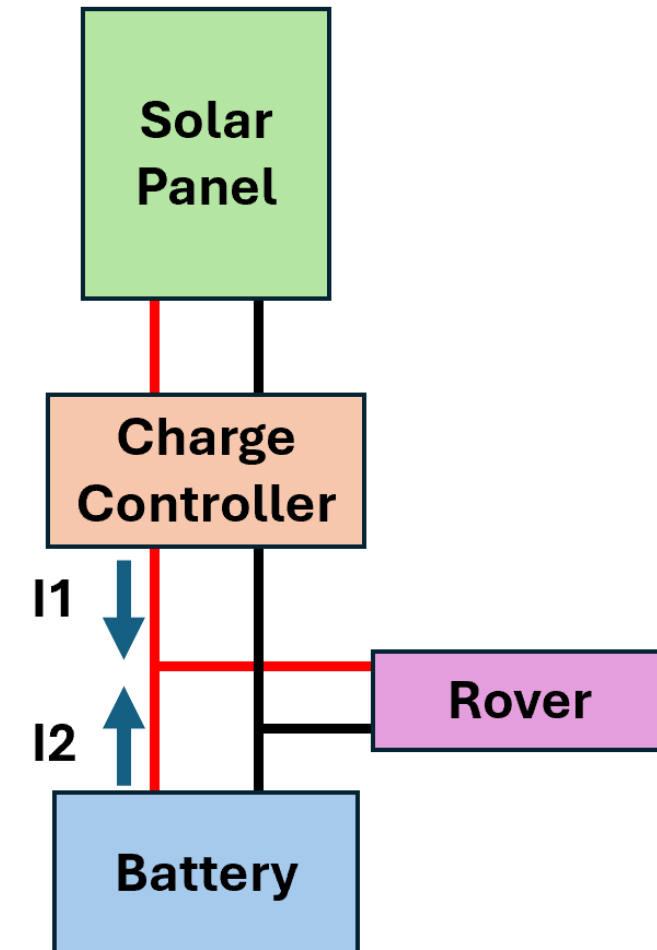
206.8% Increase



Testing and Validation: Autonomous Power Flow

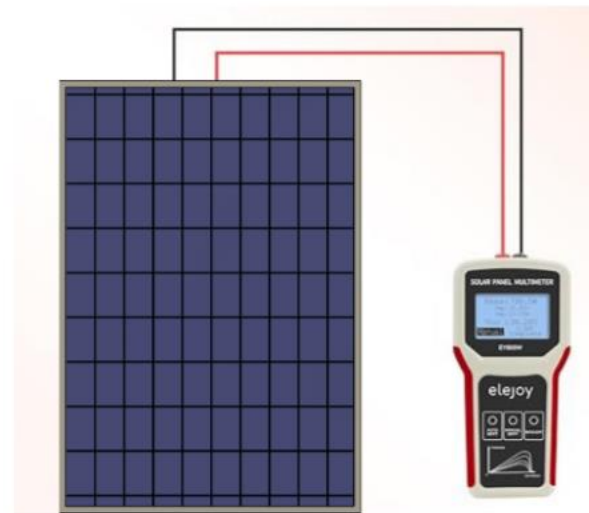
Full-Speed Current Measurements

	No Solar	Cloudy	Full Sun
PV Current (I1)		2.5A	7.7A
Battery Current (I2)	11.0A	8.8A	3.4A

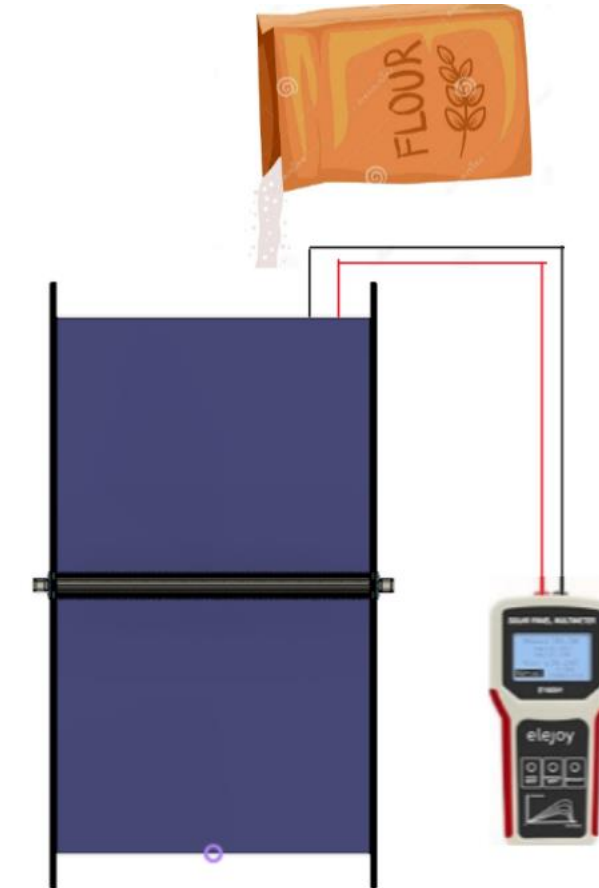


Testing and Validation: Effectiveness of the Cleaning System

$$\eta_{cleaning} = \frac{P_{after} - P_{before}}{P_{before}} \times 100\%$$



Baseline Power:



Power After Cleaning:

Testing and Validation: Effectiveness of the Cleaning System

	Current (A)	Power (W)
Before	8.00 A	450 W
During	2.25 A	125 W
After	6.5 A	350 W

180% improvement from dirty to clean

77.8% of Original Value



Testing and Validation: Activation of the Cleaning System



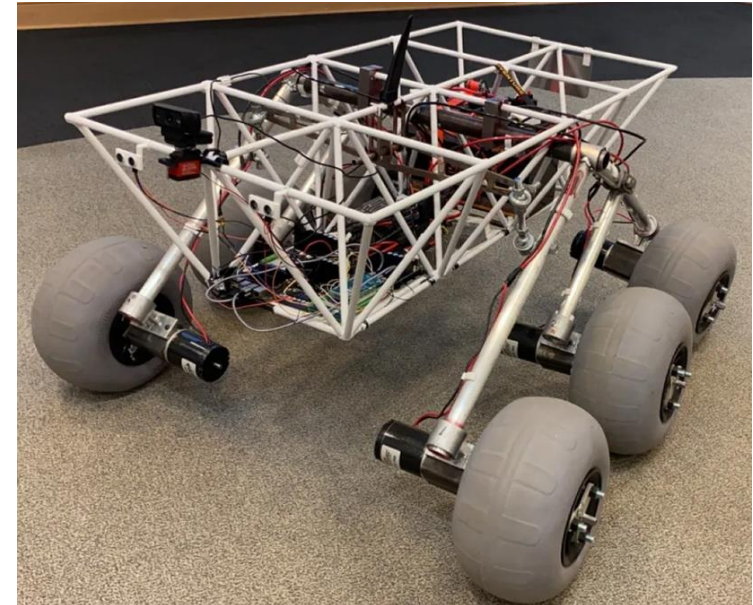
Testing and Validation: Assembly Test



Assembly:
10 Minutes



Disassembly:
6.5 Minutes



Testing and Validation: Weight, Dimensions, and Speed Test

	Original Results	New Results	Difference
Dimensions	1.25m x 1.25m x 0.625m	2.00m x 1.45m x 0.735m	+ 1.15 m ³
Weight	77.25 kg	113.4 kg	+36.2 kg
Speed	1.32 m/s	1.22 m/s	-0.1 m/s

Safety Assessment

Concern	Safety Preventative
Electrical Shock Hazard	All electrical connections on our rover are properly grounded to prevent shock hazard.
Arc Flash Hazard	All electrical connections are covered and have appropriate safety measures in place to avoid short circuiting. This will mitigate arc flashes. Bus Bars have been labeled for ease of vision.
Overcurrent	All major electrical components have incorporated fused connections that are sized properly and are expected to pop in the case of overcurrent.
Emergency Stop	There is a cancel button designed in the brush cleaning system that is designed to cancel all operation of the cleaning system in case it is needed. Labeled for ease of vision.
Audible Warning Sound	There is also a buzzer designed to trigger before the cleaning system is activated to alert all nearby prior to the cleaning system activating.
Kill Switch	There are two switches attached to the battery that can be quickly disengaged to de-energize the entire rover in the case that it is needed

Environmental Impact Assessment

- Decrease in power required from the grid
- Recyclable components
- Emission-free operation
- Testing with biodegradable materials (flour)
- Dry cleaning; no harmful chemicals



Budget

Allotted Budget: **\$4000**

Total Cost: **\$3525**

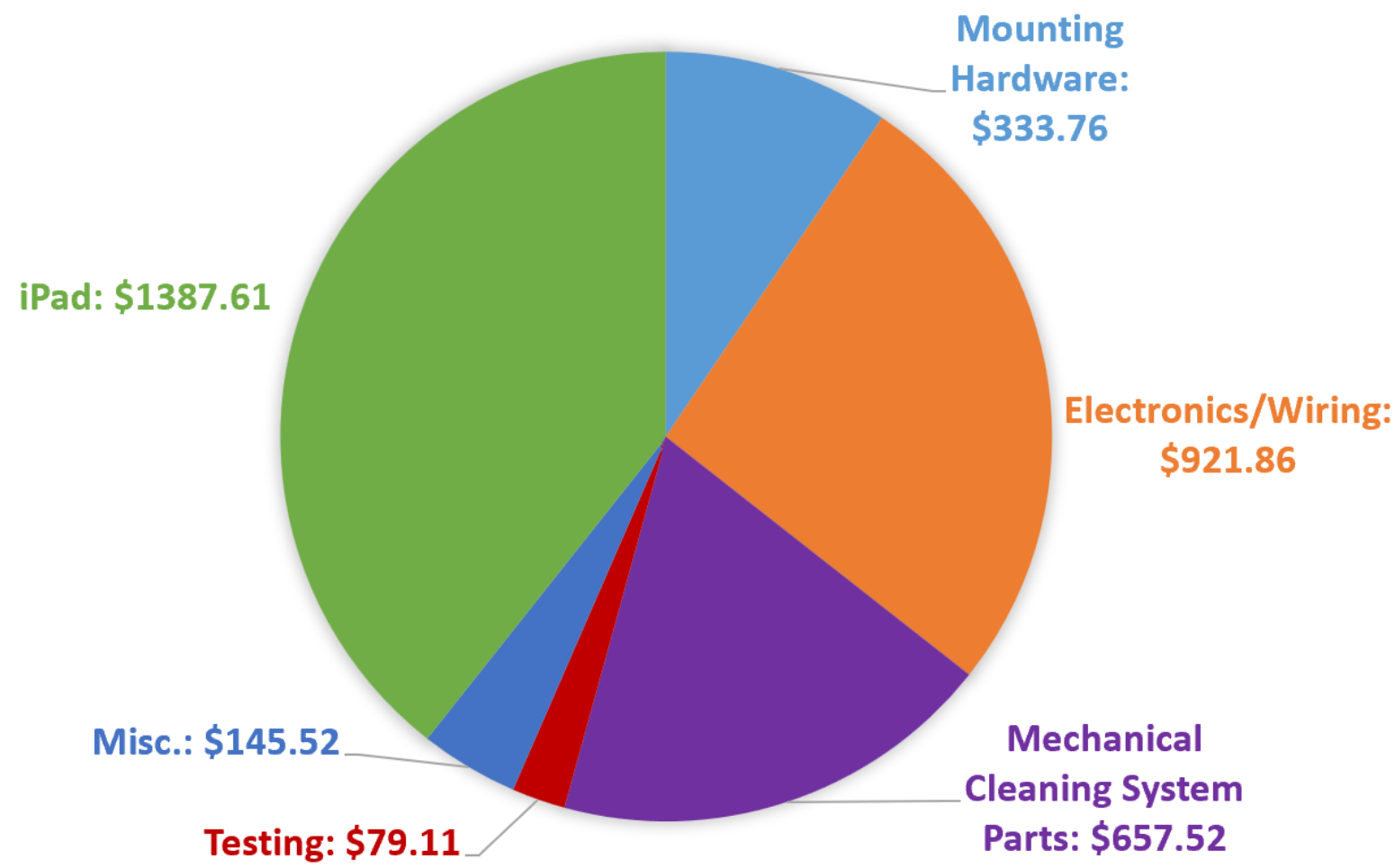
Generous Donations:

MorningStar

- TriStar Solar Charge Controller (**\$293**)

REC Solar

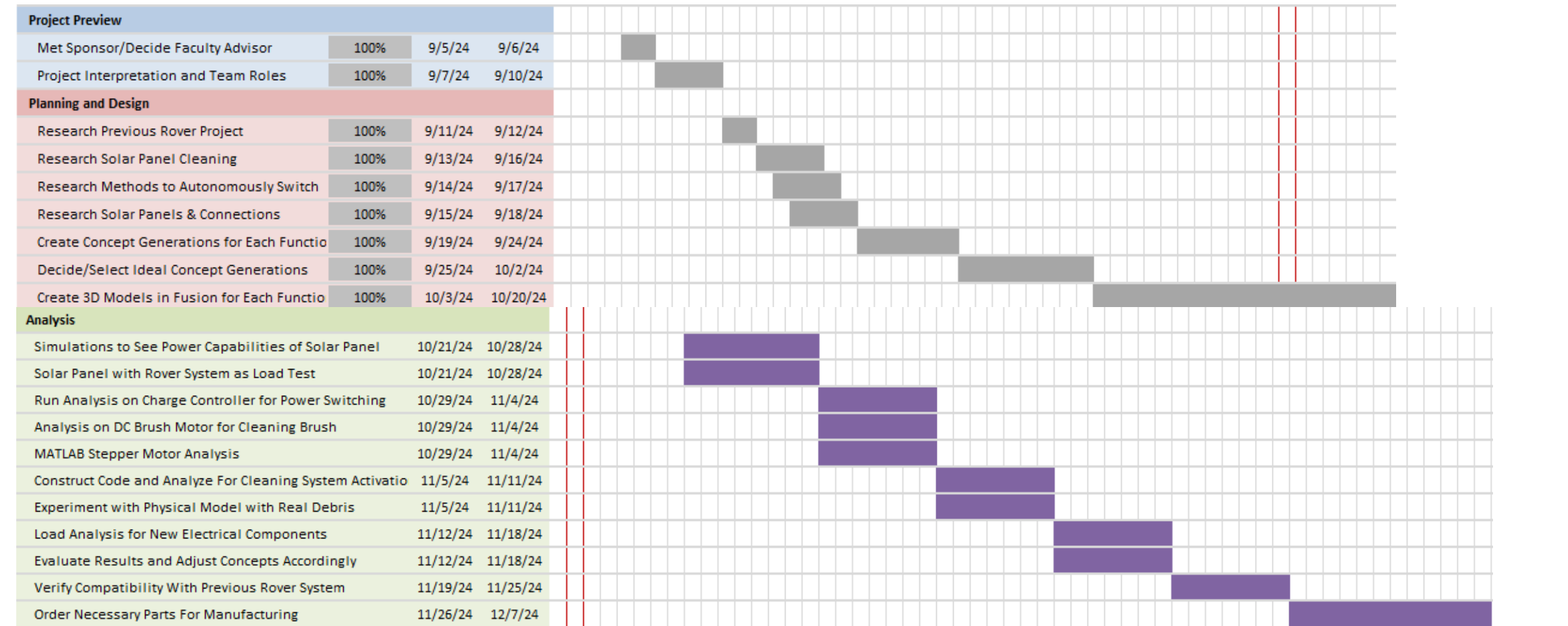
- 450W Pure-RX Solar Panel (**\$234**)



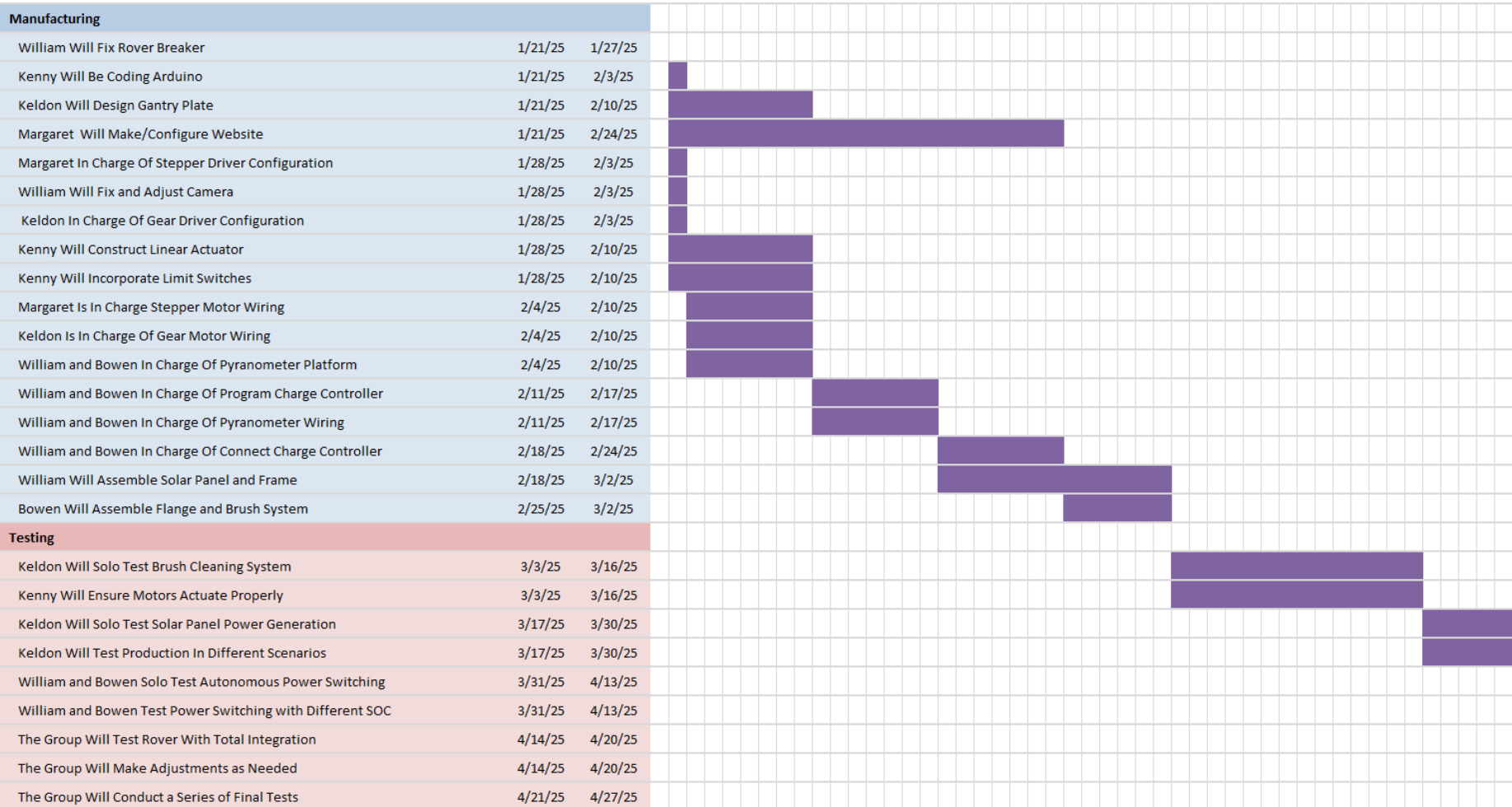
Prepared by: Kenny Bui

Presented by: Kenny Bui

Timeline:



Timeline Cont.:



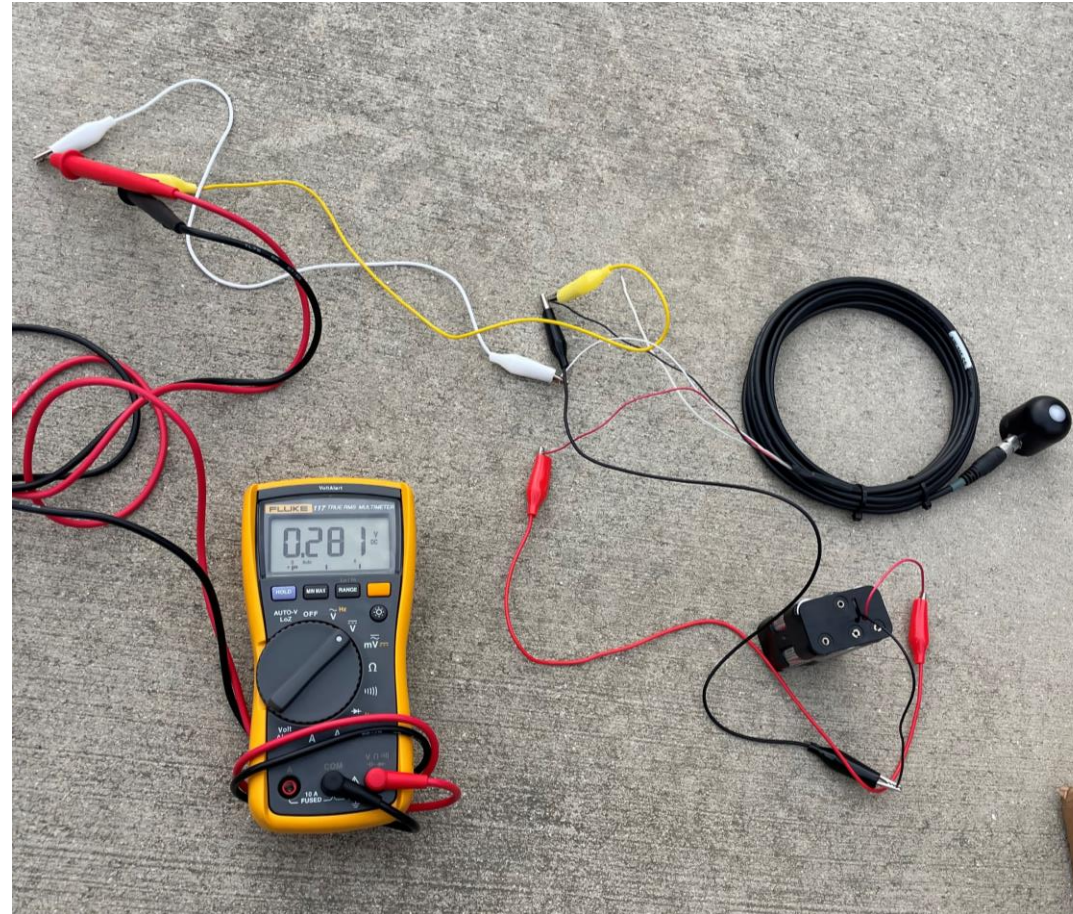
Appendix

#1	#2	#3	#4	#5	#6	#7	#8	#9	#10	#11	#12	#13
#14	#15	#16	#17	#18	#19	#20	#21	#22	#23	#24	#25	#26
#27	#28	#29	#30	#31	#32	#33	#34	#35	#36	#37	#38	#39
#40	#41	#42	#43	#44	#45	#46	#47	#48	#49	#50	#51	#52

Appendix

- [Pyranometer Measuring Procedure](#)
- [Pyranometer Testing Results](#)
- [Stepper Motor Torque](#)
- [Stepper Motor Speed](#)
- [Website-How to Work LOUIS](#)
- [Website-Maintenance Instructions](#)
- [Website-Parts List](#)
- [Website-Reference Information](#)
- [TB6600 Dip Switch Settings](#)
- [Solar Panel Efficiency Simulation](#)
- [Website- How to Disassemble LOUIS](#)
- [Website- How to Disassemble LOUIS Pt 2.](#)
- [Component Evaluation: Solar Panel](#)
- [Wiring Diagram – Overall Circuit](#)
- [Wiring Diagram – Solar Power System](#)
- [Engineering Analysis: Cleaning Activation Engineering Analysis: Charge Controller](#)
- [Interior Space](#)
- [Existing and Competing Technologies:](#)
- [Nema 23 Stepper Motor](#)
- [Concept Evaluation & Selection: Autonomous Power Switching](#)

Pyranometer Measuring Procedure



Pyranometer Testing Results

3/13

Time:	Reading:	Weather:
10:56AM	1.60V	Partly Cloudy
10:57AM	1.717V	Partly Cloudy
10:59AM	1.714V	Partly Cloudy
11:00AM	1.770V	Partly Cloudy
11:01AM	1.777V	Partly Cloudy
11:02AM	1.270V	Partly Cloudy
11:03AM	0.498V	Shadow
11:05AM	0.742V	Cloudy
11:06AM	1.158V	Cloudy
11:08AM	1.941V	Partly Cloudy
11:09AM	1.950V	Sunny
11:11AM	2.010V	Sunny
11:11AM	0.685V	Shadow
11:34AM	0.003V	Indoor
11:36AM	0.004V	Indoor
11:36AM	0.000V	Shadow and Indoor

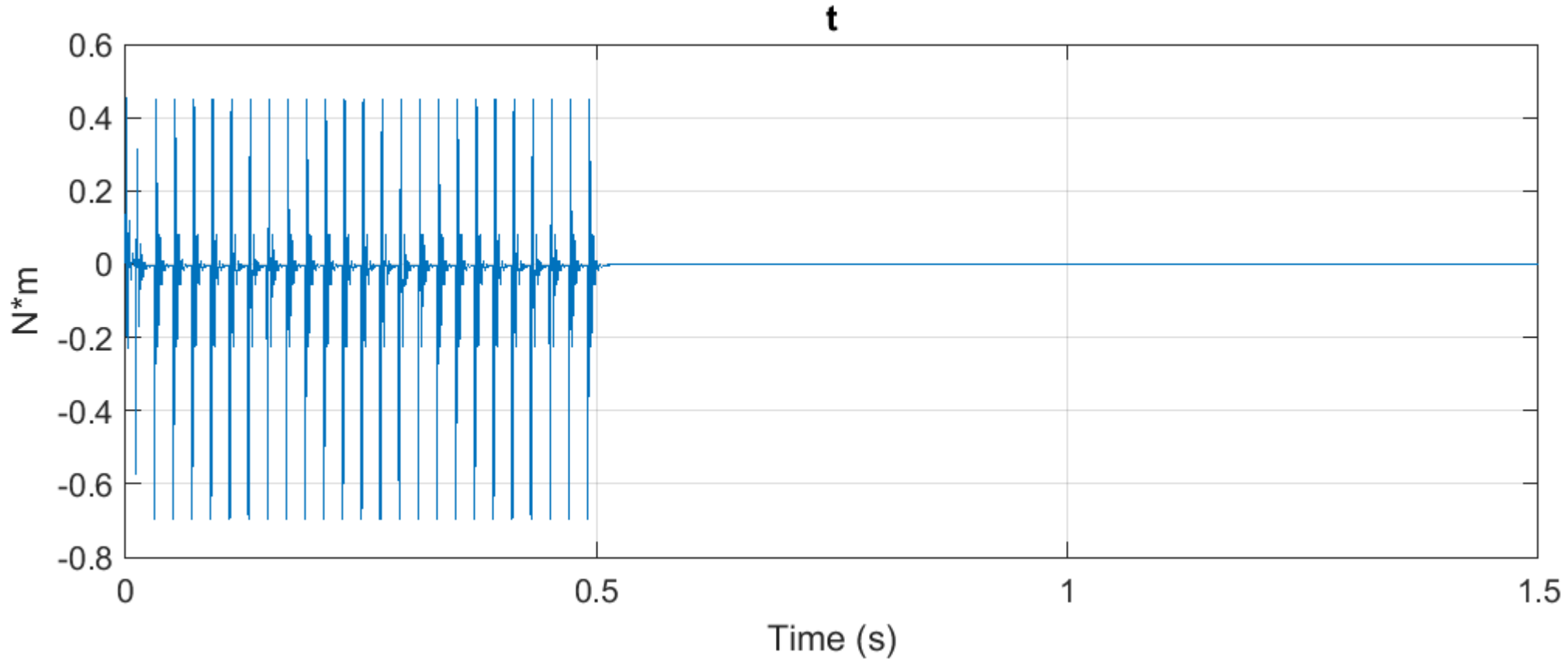
3/18

Time:	Reading:	Weather:
9:47AM	1.517V	Sunny
9:47AM	1.530V	Sunny
9:48AM	1.533V	Sunny
9:48AM	1.546V	Sunny
9:49AM	0.158V	Shadow
9:49AM	1.463V	Sunny
9:50AM	0.165V	Shadow
9:51AM	1.470V	Sunny
9:51AM	1.482V	Sunny
9:52AM	1.460V	Sunny
9:55AM	0.362V	Shadow
9:55AM	0.400V	Shadow
9:56AM	0.392V	Shadow
9:57AM	1.685V	Sunny
9:58AM	1.780V	Sunny
9:59AM	1.882V	Sunny

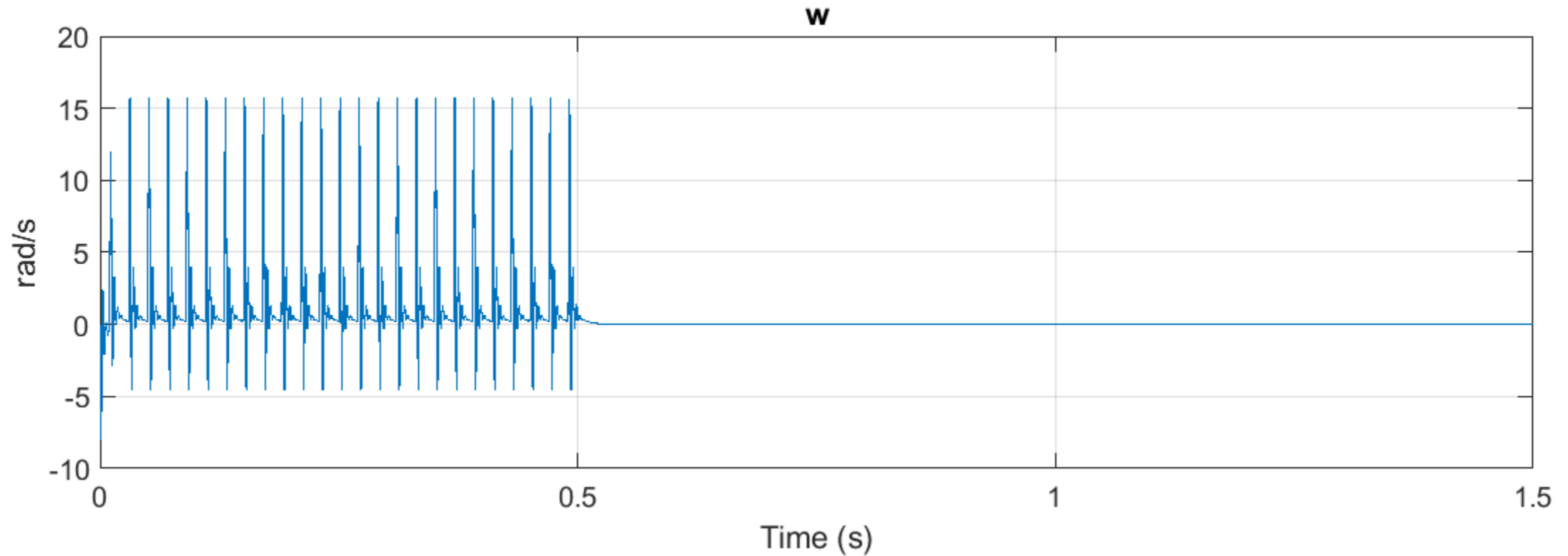
3/19

Time:	Reading:	Condition:
2:42PM	0.637V	Cloudy
2:42PM	0.627V	Cloudy
2:43PM	0.615V	Cloudy
2:43PM	0.592V	Cloudy
2:44PM	0.583V	Cloudy
5:49PM	0.328V	Partly Cloudy
5:50PM	0.299V	Partly Cloudy
5:50PM	0.242V	Partly Cloudy + Shadow
5:49PM	0.328V	Partly Cloudy
5:49PM	0.314V	Partly Cloudy
5:50PM	0.309V	Partly Cloudy
7:15PM	0.008V	Partly Cloudy
7:16PM	0.004V	Partly Cloudy and Shade

Stepper Motor Torque



Stepper Motor Speed



Website-How to Work LOUIS

LOUIS Project - How to Work LOUIS

Home How to Work LOUIS Maintenance Instructions Parts List Reference Information How to Disassemble LOUIS

How to Turn on LOUIS

The following guide will help you operate and understand LOUIS.

Step 1: Turn on Battery Power for the Charge Controller Switch



On the side of the battery, there is a switch with a battery icon. Turn this on to start.

Step 2: Turn on the Rocker Switch for the Solar Panel



On the side of the charge controller, this is a rocker switch. Turn this on.

Website-Maintenance Instructions

LOUIS Project - Maintenance Instructions

[Home](#) [How to Work LOUIS](#) [Maintenance Instructions](#) [Parts List](#) [Reference Information](#) [How to Disassemble LOUIS](#)

Maintenance Instructions

Brush



When to Replace:

- For reference, it was first used in February of 2025.
- As a general rule of thumb, the brush should be replaced every 6-12 months.
- **OR** if there are worn, damaged, or frayed bristles, consider replacing the brush to minimize damage to the solar panel.
- **OR** if the brush does not effectively remove debris, consider replacing the brush to maximize the solar panel's efficiency.

Website-Parts List

Parts List			
Search for parts...			
Component	Manufacturer	Link	Extra Details
Tufted Brush	Industrial Brush Corp	None. You have to email the company for customized brushes.	.012 crimped natural 6-6 nylon 44" x 4" OD 18 row x 5/8" OC 44" OAL x 1-1/2" OD x 3/4" ID No end fittings
4 Gauge Wire	GearIT	View Product	25 feet each-black/red translucent
Waterproof 100Amp Circuit Breaker	RED WOLF	View Product	
TB6600 Stepper Motor Driver	OUIZGIA	View Product	For NEMA 23 stepper motor
Arduino Uno Rev3	Arduino	View Product	
L298N Motor Driver	Generic	View Product	

Website-Reference Information

Reference Info

Explore the PowerPoints and other documents shown below for more background information.

Project #57

CPFR:

[Download PDF](#)

FEMD:

[Download PDF](#)

CPFPS:

[Download PDF](#)

CPP:

[Download PDF](#)

Project #66

EATB:

[Download PDF](#)

FDPR:

[Download PDF](#)

ESIR:

[Download PDF](#)

PiTA:

[Download PDF](#)

Battery Monitoring

Monitor the Enduro 36V battery life with the Enduro Power App.

[Open Enduro Power App](#)

Website- How to Disassemble LOUIS

LOUIS Project - How to Disassemble LOUIS

[Home](#)[How to Work LOUIS](#)[Maintenance Instructions](#)[Parts List](#)[Reference Information](#)[How to Disassemble LOUIS](#)

How to Disassemble LOUIS

The following guide will help you disassemble LOUIS for transportation purposes. The disassembly takes around 6.5 minutes, while the assembly time takes around 10 minutes.

The rover's fully assembled state has the solar panel charge controller system fully connected and the cleaning system fully connected to the arduino. A detailed wiring diagram will also be included to make sure all the wires are correctly reassembled. Before doing any work make sure all power is off.

Step 1: Unscrew Electrical Conduit Straps

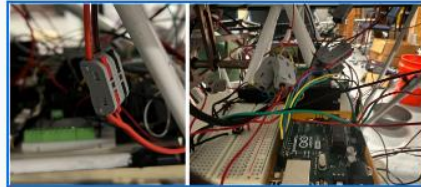


To begin disassembly, first start by unscrewing all of the electrical conduit straps from underneath the panel and frame. There are 4 straps with 2 screws each.

Note: Having partners for the next portion of the disassembly can make the job much easier by having them lift the panel slightly to get to any hard to reach screws.

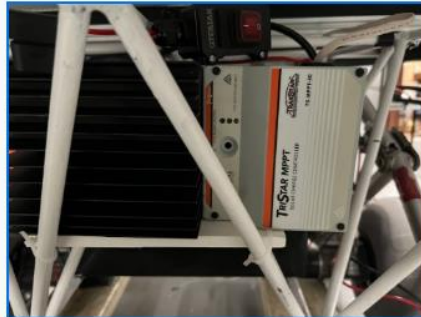
Website- How to Disassemble LOUIS Pt 2.

Step 2: Disconnect Quick Connections



The next step, move to the front of the rover, and begin disconnecting all wiring to the stepper motors and rotational motors, using their quick connections to their motor driver. These clips make it easier to unwire and rewire the small connections. This also goes for the connections to the limit switches in the arduino.

Step 3: Unscrew Charge Controller Face and Panel Wires

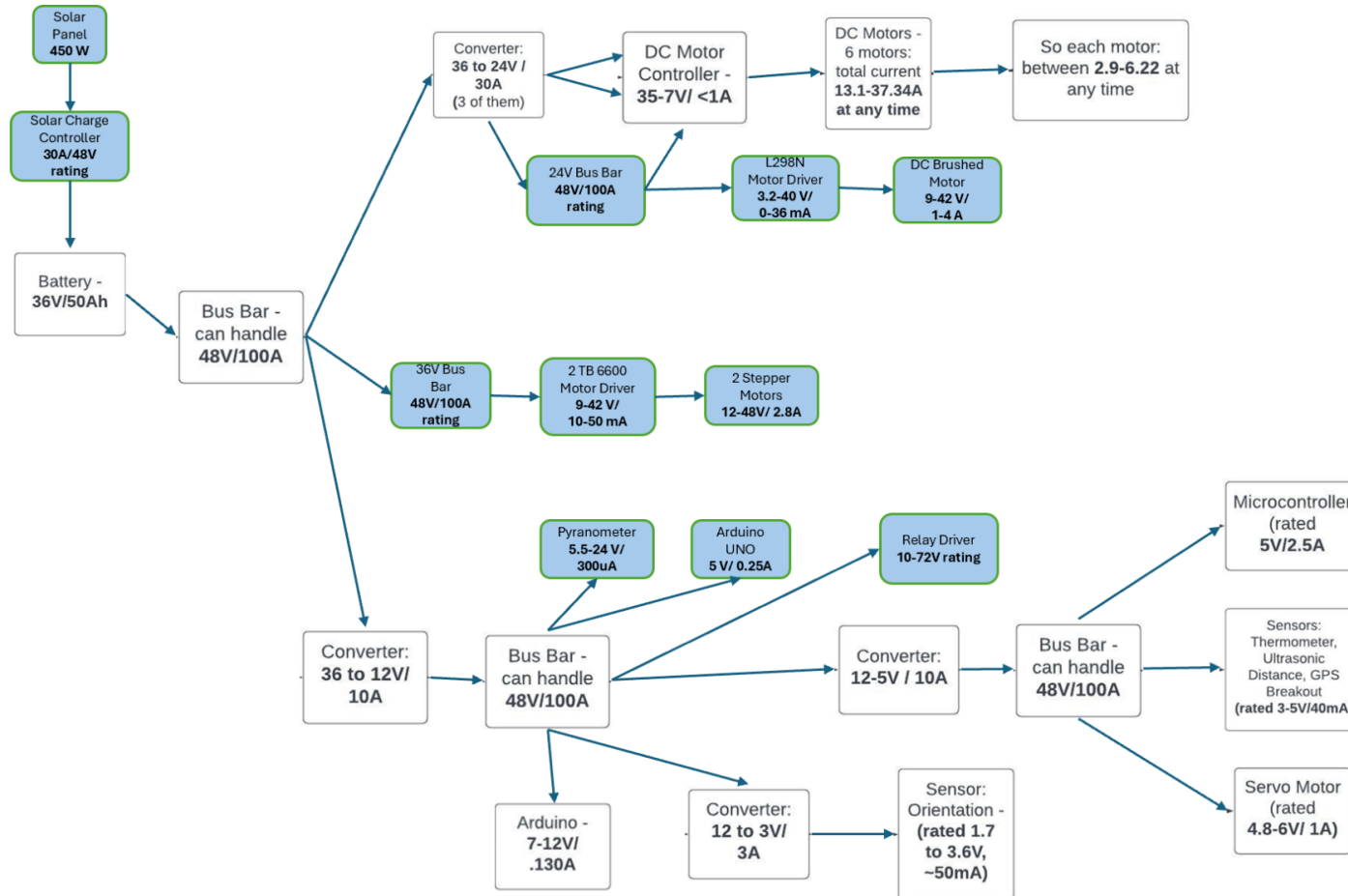


Finally move to the back of the rover to find the solar charge controller and begin removing the 4 screws from the face of the controller. Once that is removed, unscrew the panel wires connected to the points labeled array, and the ground. (The PV wires are the thin ones, the thick battery wires can be left alone.)

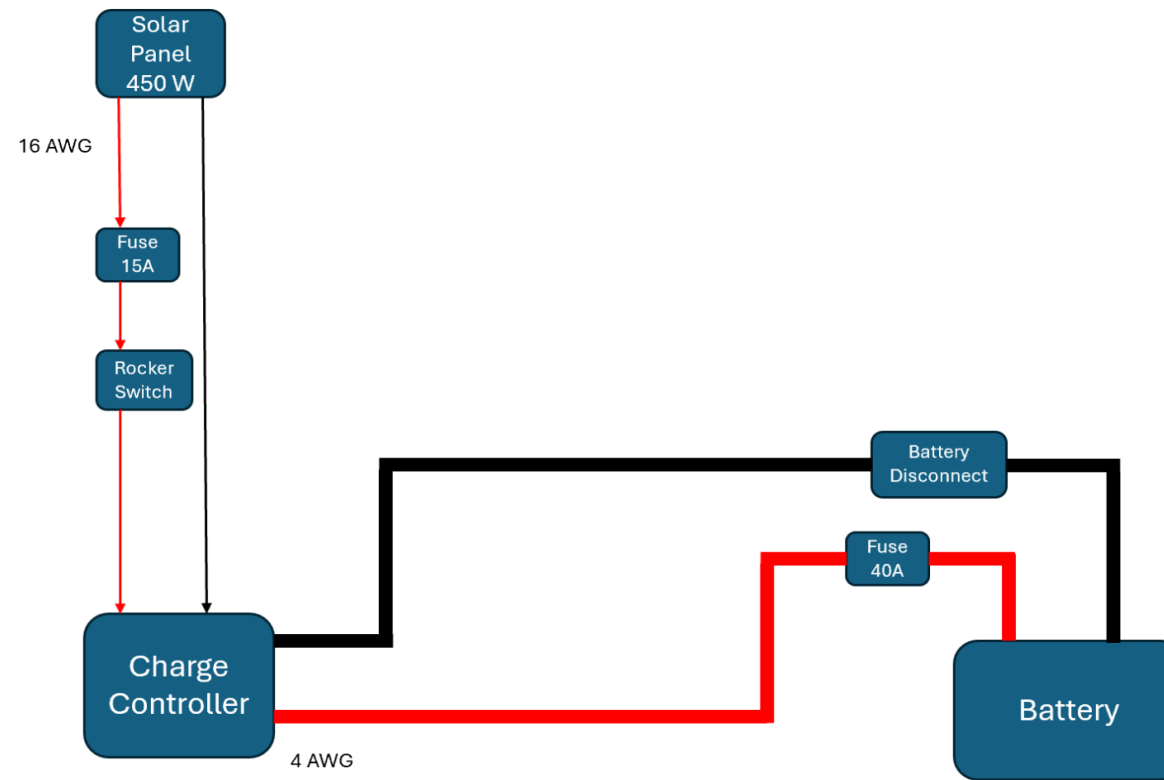
Step 4: Remove the Panel

After all this is complete, the panel can be lifted and removed by two people. For the safety of the equipment, it is recommended that the panel be lifted by the spots where the underneath t-track rails and the linear actuator rails meet. It should also be set down on the cable carrier L-Bars to protect the panel.

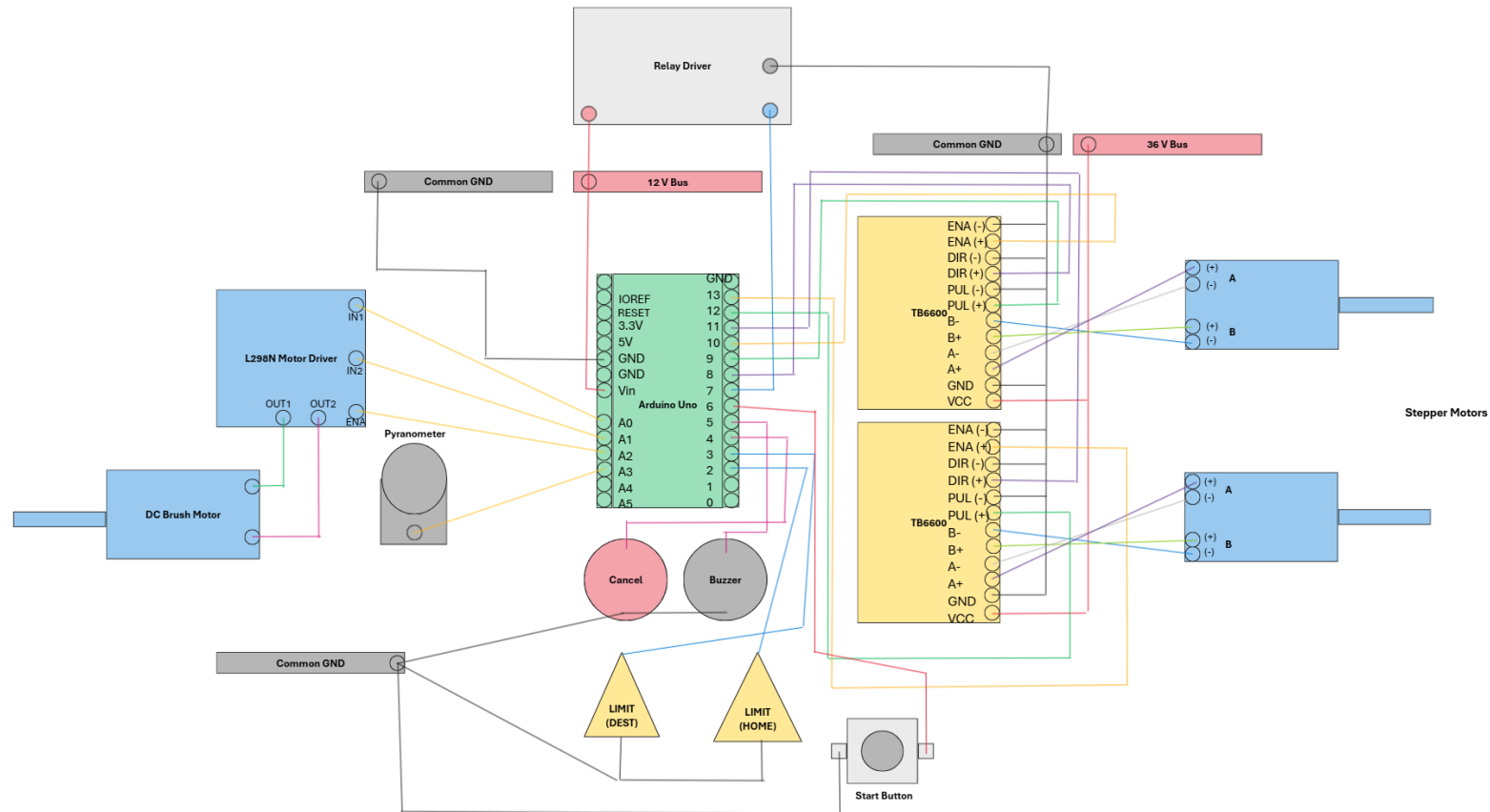
Wiring Diagram – Overall Circuit



Wiring Diagram – Solar Power System



Wiring Diagram – Electronics



Engineering Analysis: Cleaning Activation

```
1 // Stepper 1
2 #define DIR_PIN 8
3 #define STEP_PIN 9
4 #define ENABLE_PIN 10
5
6 // Stepper 2
7 #define DIR2_PIN 11
8 #define STEP2_PIN 12
9 #define ENABLE2_PIN 13
10
11 // Control buttons and sensors
12 #define LIMIT_HOME 2
13 #define LIMIT_DEST 3
14 #define CANCEL_BUTTON 4
15 #define BUZZER 5
16 #define START_BUTTON 6
17 #define RELAY_PIN 7
18
19 // Brush Motor (L298N)
20 #define BRUSH_IN1 A0
21 #define BRUSH_IN2 A1
22 #define BRUSH_EN A2
23
24 // Pyranometer (SP-215-SS)
25 #define PYRA_PIN A3
26 #define PYRA_THRESHOLD 300
27 #define ADC_TO_VOLTAGE 0.0048876
28 #define VOLTAGE_TO_Wm2 250
29
30 // Ramping config
31 #define STEP_DELAY_START 1000
32 #define STEP_DELAY_MIN 200
33 #define STEP_RAMP_STEPS 300
34
35 // Auto trigger hold timer
36 unsigned long autoTriggerStartTime = 0;
37 const unsigned long AUTO_TRIGGER_DELAY = 60000; //
38
39 bool cancelTriggered = false;
40
41
42 void moveToLimit(int limitSwitch, bool direction);
43 void returnHome();
44 void stepMotors(int delayMicros);
45 void enableMotors();
46 void stopMotors();
47 void startBrushMotor(bool forward = true);
48 void stopBrushMotor();
49 void buzzerAlert();
50 void emergencyStopAndWait();
51 void runCleaningCycle();
52
53 void setup() {
54   Serial.begin(9600);
55
56   // Stepper pins
57   pinMode(DIR_PIN, OUTPUT); pinMode(STEP_PIN, OUTPUT); pinMode(ENABLE_PIN, OUTPUT);
58   pinMode(DIR2_PIN, OUTPUT); pinMode(STEP2_PIN, OUTPUT); pinMode(ENABLE2_PIN, OUTPUT);
59   digitalWrite(ENABLE_PIN, HIGH); digitalWrite(ENABLE2_PIN, HIGH);
60
61   // Brush motor
62   pinMode(BRUSH_IN1, OUTPUT); pinMode(BRUSH_IN2, OUTPUT); pinMode(BRUSH_EN, OUTPUT);
63   stopBrushMotor();
64
65   // Inputs
66   pinMode(LIMIT_HOME, INPUT_PULLUP);
67   pinMode(LIMIT_DEST, INPUT_PULLUP);
68   pinMode(CANCEL_BUTTON, INPUT_PULLUP);
69   pinMode(START_BUTTON, INPUT_PULLUP);
70   pinMode(RELAY_PIN, INPUT_PULLUP);
71   pinMode(PYRA_PIN, INPUT);
72
73   pinMode(BUZZER, OUTPUT); digitalWrite(BUZZER, LOW);
74
75   Serial.println("System ready. Monitoring for manual or automatic cleaning...");
76 }
```

Engineering Analysis: Cleaning Activation

```

78 void loop() {
79     int relayState = digitalRead(RELAY_PIN);
80     int pyranometerRaw = analogRead(PYRA_PIN);
81     float pyranometerVoltage = pyranometerRaw * ADC_TO_VOLTAGE;
82     float irradianceWm2 = pyranometerVoltage * VOLTAGE_TO_Wm2;
83     bool manualStartTriggered = digitalRead(START_BUTTON) == LOW;
84
85     Serial.print("Pyranometer: ");
86     Serial.print(pyranometerRaw);
87     Serial.print(" (");
88     Serial.print(irradianceWm2);
89     Serial.println(" W/m²");
90
91     // Manual Start (instant)
92     if (manualStartTriggered) {
93         Serial.println("Manual START button pressed. Beginning cleaning...");
94         while (digitalRead(START_BUTTON) == LOW); // Debounce
95         runCleaningCycle();
96         return;
97     }
98
99     // Auto Start (trigger when relay is LOW)
100    if (relayState == LOW && pyranometerRaw >= PYRA_THRESHOLD) {
101        if (autoTriggerStartTime == 0) {
102            autoTriggerStartTime = millis();
103            Serial.println("Auto trigger detected. Holding for 30 seconds...");
104        } else if (millis() - autoTriggerStartTime >= AUTO_TRIGGER_DELAY) {
105            Serial.println("Auto trigger held 30 seconds. Starting cleaning...");
106            runCleaningCycle();
107            autoTriggerStartTime = 0;
108            return;
109        } else {
110            Serial.print("Auto trigger duration: ");
111            Serial.print((millis() - autoTriggerStartTime) / 1000);
112            Serial.println(" sec");
113        }
114    } else {
115        if (autoTriggerStartTime > 0) {
116            Serial.println("Auto trigger reset (conditions dropped).");
117            autoTriggerStartTime = 0;
118        }
119    }
120
121    delay(1000);
122
123
124 void runCleaningCycle() {
125     cancelTriggered = false;
126     enableMotors();
127     buzzerAlert();
128
129     moveToLimit(LIMIT_DEST, HIGH);
130     if (cancelTriggered) return;
131
132     delay(1000);
133     returnHome();
134     if (cancelTriggered) return;
135
136     stopMotors();
137     delay(5000);
138     enableMotors();
139 }

```

Engineering Analysis: Cleaning Activation

```

141 void moveToLimit(int limitSwitch, bool direction) {
142     digitalWrite(DIR_PIN, direction);
143     digitalWrite(DIR2_PIN, !direction);
144     startBrushMotor(true);
145
146     int stepCount = 0;
147     while (digitalRead(limitSwitch) == HIGH) {
148         if (digitalRead(CANCEL_BUTTON) == LOW) {
149             Serial.println("Cancel pressed: stopping...");
150             stopBrushMotor();
151             stopMotors();
152             cancelTriggered = true;
153
154             Serial.println("Press START to return home...");
155             while (digitalRead(START_BUTTON) == HIGH);
156             while (digitalRead(START_BUTTON) == LOW);
157
158             returnHome();
159             return;
160         }
161
162         int delayMicros = STEP_DELAY_START;
163         if (stepCount < STEP_RAMP_STEPS) {
164             delayMicros = STEP_DELAY_START - ((STEP_DELAY_START - STEP_DELAY_MIN) * stepCount / STEP_RAMP_STEPS);
165         } else {
166             delayMicros = STEP_DELAY_MIN;
167         }
168
169         stepMotors(delayMicros);
170         stepCount++;
171     }
172
173     stopBrushMotor();

```

```

176 void returnHome() {
177     digitalWrite(DIR_PIN, LOW);
178     digitalWrite(DIR2_PIN, HIGH);
179     enableMotors();
180     startBrushMotor(false);
181
182     int stepCount = 0;
183     while (digitalRead(LIMIT_HOME) == HIGH) {
184         int delayMicros = STEP_DELAY_START;
185         if (stepCount < STEP_RAMP_STEPS) {
186             delayMicros = STEP_DELAY_START - ((STEP_DELAY_START - STEP_DELAY_MIN) * stepCount / STEP_RAMP_STEPS);
187         } else {
188             delayMicros = STEP_DELAY_MIN;
189         }
190
191         stepMotors(delayMicros);
192         stepCount++;
193     }
194
195     stopBrushMotor();
196     stopMotors();
197 }
198
199 void stepMotors(int delayMicros) {
200     digitalWrite(STEP_PIN, HIGH); digitalWrite(STEP2_PIN, HIGH);
201     delayMicroseconds(delayMicros);
202     digitalWrite(STEP_PIN, LOW); digitalWrite(STEP2_PIN, LOW);
203     delayMicroseconds(delayMicros);

```

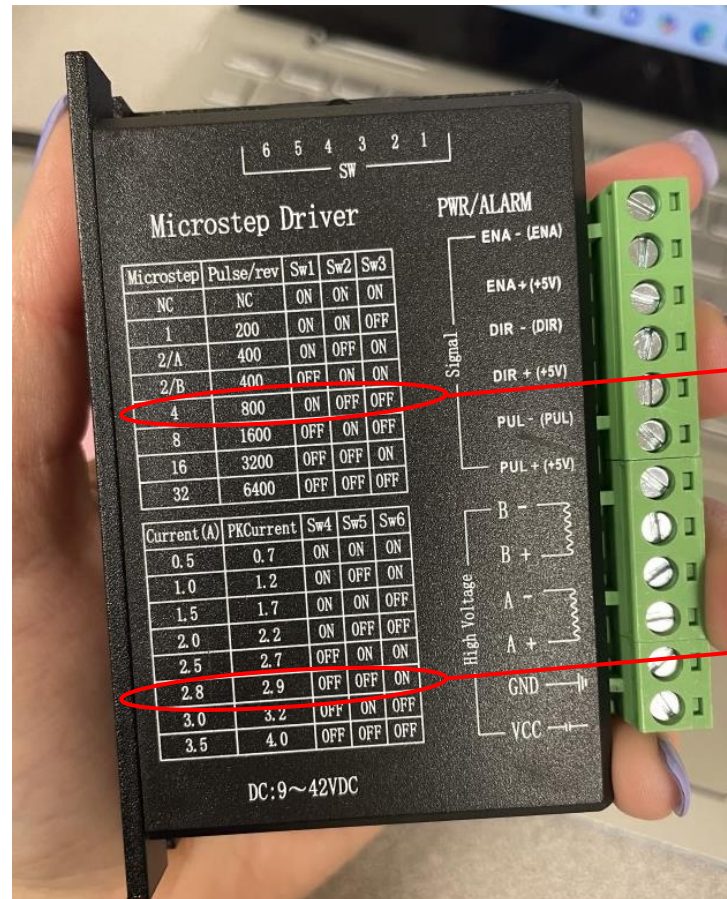

Engineering Analysis: Cleaning Activation

```

206 void enableMotors() {
207     digitalWrite(ENABLE_PIN, LOW);
208     digitalWrite(ENABLE2_PIN, LOW);
209     Serial.println("Motors enabled.");
210 }
211
212 void stopMotors() {
213     digitalWrite(ENABLE_PIN, HIGH);
214     digitalWrite(ENABLE2_PIN, HIGH);
215     Serial.println("Motors disabled.");
216 }
217
218 void startBrushMotor(bool forward) {
219     if (forward) {
220         digitalWrite(BRUSH_IN1, HIGH);
221         digitalWrite(BRUSH_IN2, LOW);
222     } else {
223         digitalWrite(BRUSH_IN1, LOW);
224         digitalWrite(BRUSH_IN2, HIGH);
225     }
226     analogWrite(BRUSH_EN, 255);
229
230 void stopBrushMotor() {
231     digitalWrite(BRUSH_IN1, LOW);
232     digitalWrite(BRUSH_IN2, LOW);
233     analogWrite(BRUSH_EN, 0);
234 }
235
236 void buzzerAlert() {
237     for (int i = 0; i < 10; i++) {
238         digitalWrite(BUZZER, HIGH);
239         delay(250);
240         digitalWrite(BUZZER, LOW);
241         delay(250);
242     }
243 }
244
245 void emergencyStopAndWait() {
246     stopBrushMotor();
247     stopMotors();
248     cancelTriggered = true;
249     Serial.println("Cycle halted. Press START to return home.");
250
251     while (digitalRead(START_BUTTON) == HIGH);
252     while (digitalRead(START_BUTTON) == LOW);
253
254     returnHome();

```

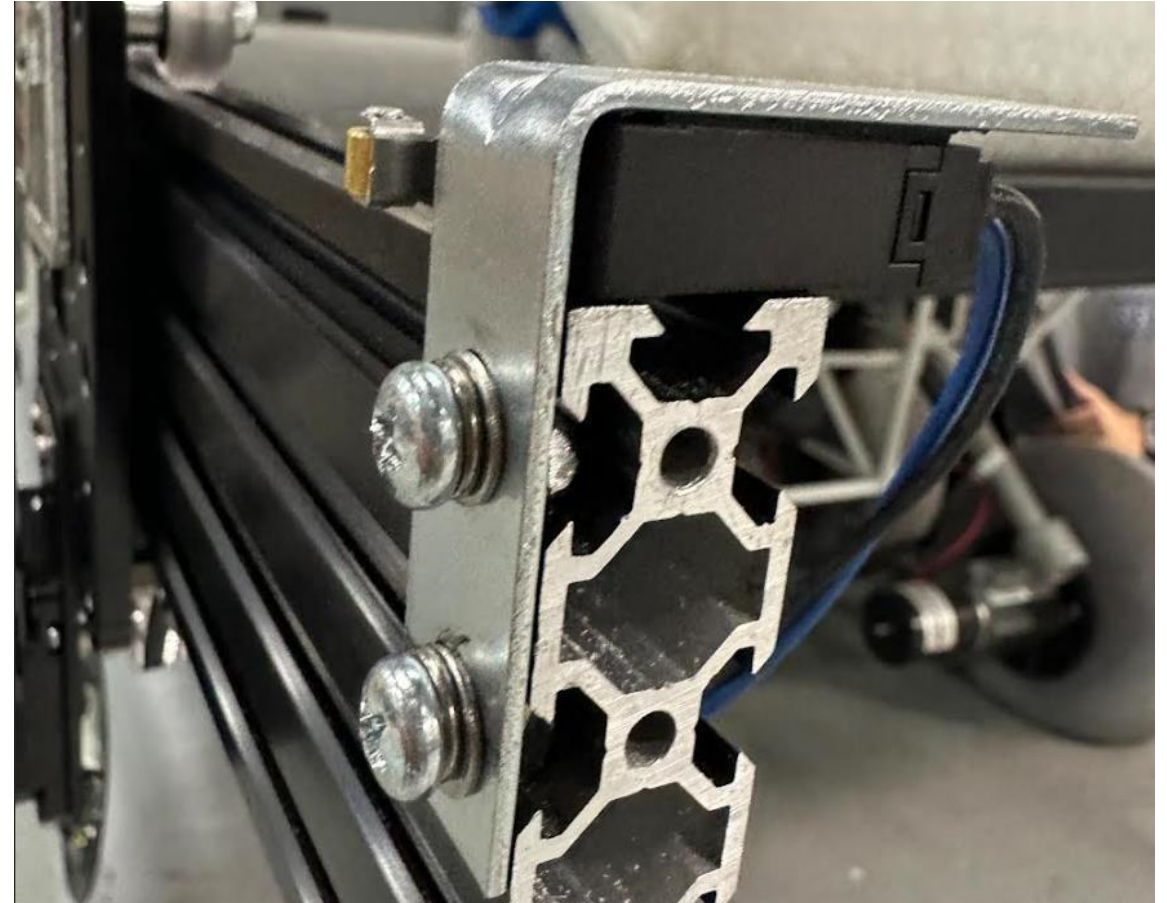
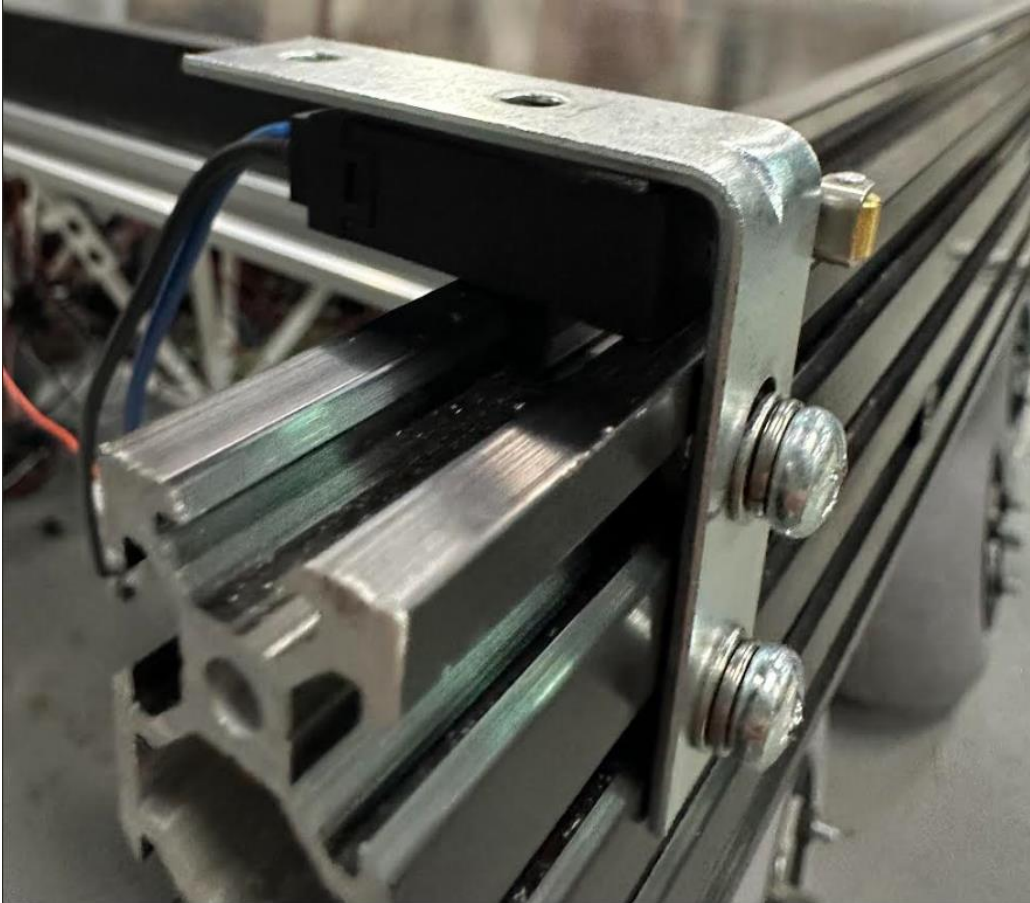
TB6600 Dip Switch Settings

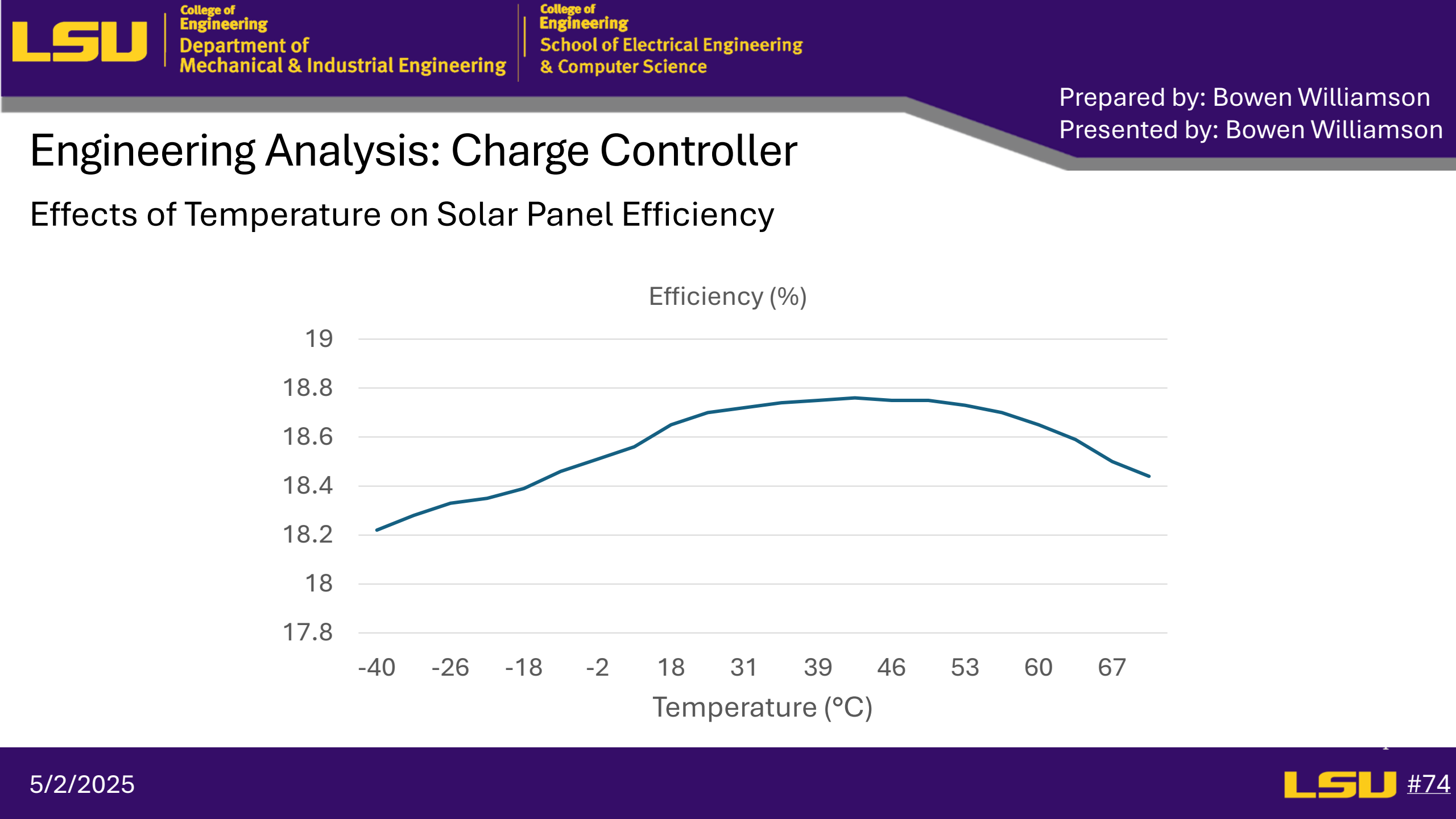


Quarter-Stepping Mode

Operating Current of the Motor is 2.8A

Limit Switch Manufacturing



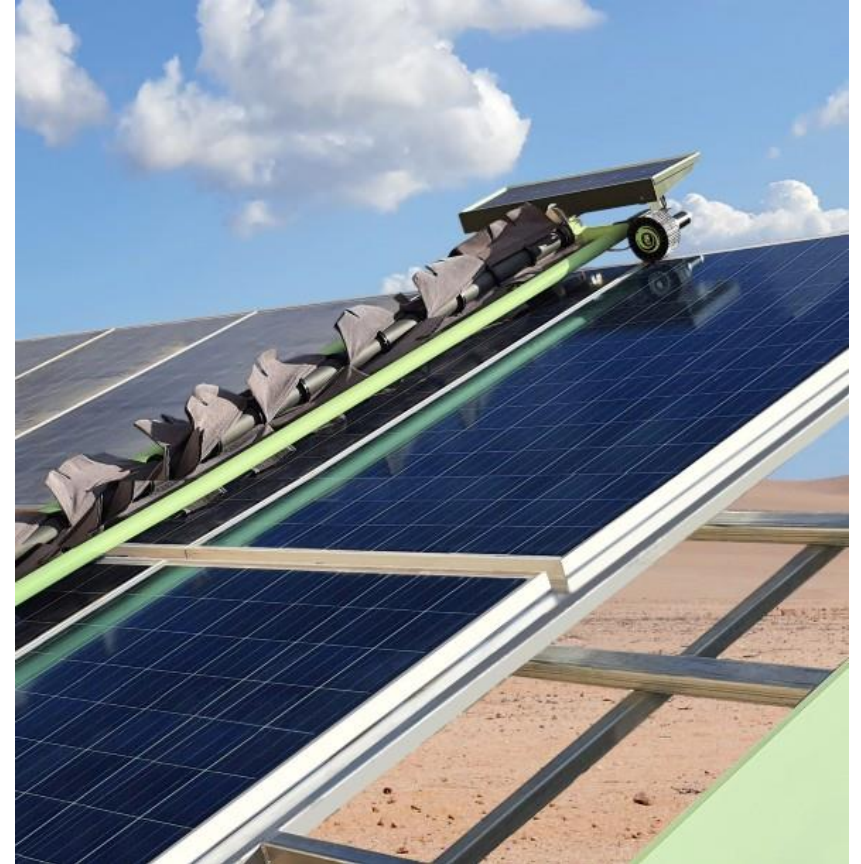


Interior Space

Components	Volume (M^3)		
L298N	0.000049851		
TB6600 (2)	0.000354816		
Arduino Uno	0.000054909		
TriStar	0.005378		
RD-1	0.0004346		
Bus Bar (3)	0.0000648		
	0.006336976		
Original Volume	Occupied Space		
0.977	0.006336976	0.970663024	

Existing and Competing Technologies:

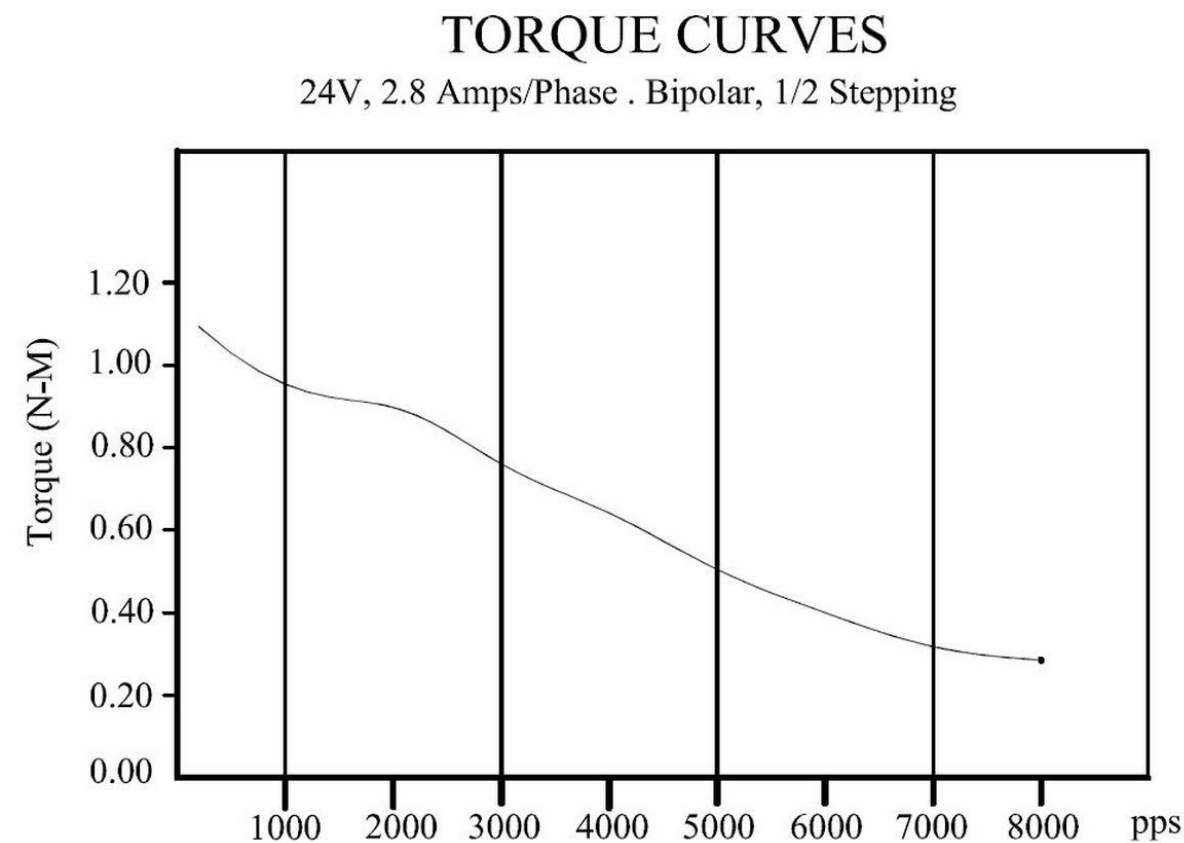
- Ecoppia E4:
 - Key similarities
 - Solar panel cleaning robot
 - Bi-directional cleaning
 - Key Differences
 - Smart row scanning
 - Speed adaptability



Component Evaluation: Solar Panel

		Concepts		
Criterion	Weights	LG Neon	Candian Solar TOPHiKu6	REC Alpha
Size	40	0	0	1
Efficiency	40	-1	1	1
Cost	20	0	0	1
Weighted Total	100	-0.4	0.4	1

Nema 23 Stepper Motor



Items	Specs
Phase Number	2 phases
Driving Voltage	12-48V
Resistance(20°C)	1.1±10% Ω / phase
Holding Torque	175 Oz.in
Detent Torque	400 g.cm
Rotor Inertia	300 g.cm ²
Step Angle	1.8° ± 5%
Rated Current	2.8A / phase
Inductance	3.0±20% mH/ phase
Weight	0.75 kg

Concept Evaluation & Selection: Autonomous Power Switching

		Concepts		
Criterion	Weights	Voltage Regulator with Arduino	DC/DC Converter with Arduino	Solar Charge Controller
Functional Accuracy	45	-1	0	1
Simplicity	25	0	-1	1
Programmability	20	-1	0	1
Cost	10	1	0	-1
Weighted Total	100	-0.55	-0.25	0.8